Plauto · *Anfitrión*

Texto en latín y traducción inglesa alineados por pasaje; cada sección de la traducción figura una sola vez, junto al primer pasaje que abarca.

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Disposición: el texto latino de cada grupo de pasajes va seguido de la sección correspondiente de la traducción inglesa.

prologue.pr.1

1 Vt vos in vostris voltis mercimoniis
2 emundis vendundisque me laetum lucris
3 adficere atque adiuvare in rebus omnibus
4 et ut res rationesque vostrorum omnium
5 bene me expedire voltis peregrique et domi
6 bonoque atque amplo auctare perpetuo lucro
7 quasque incepistis res quasque inceptabitis,
8 et uti bonis vos vostrosque omnis nuntiis
9 me adficere voltis, ea adferam, ea uti nuntiem
10 quae maxime in rem vostram communem sient
11 (nam vos quidem id iam scitis concessum et datum
12 mi esse ab dis aliis, nuntiis praesim et lucro):
13 haec ut me voltis adprobare adnitier,
14
15 ita huic facietis fabulae silentium
16 itaque aequi et iusti hic eritis omnes arbitri.
17 Nunc cuius iussu venio et quam ob rem venerim
18 dicam simulque ipse eloquar nomen meum.
19 Iovis iússu venio, nomen Mercurio est mihi.
20 pater huc me misit ad vos oratum meus,
21 tam etsi, pro imperio vobis quod dictum foret,
22 scibat facturos, quippe qui intellexerat
23 vereri vos se et metuere, ita ut aequom est Iovem;
24 verum profecto hoc petere me precario
25 a vobis iussit, leniter, dictis bonis.
26 etenim ille, cuius huc iussu venio, Iuppiter
27 non minus quam vostrum quivis formidat malum:
28 humana matre natus, humano patre,
29 mirari non est aequom, sibi si praetimet;
30 atque ego quoque etiam, qui Iovis sum filius,

1 As, in purchasing and selling your merchandize, you are desirous to render me propitious to your bargains, and that I should assist you in all things; and as both in foreign countries and at home, you desire me to turn to the best advantage the business and the accounts of you all, 6 and that with fair and ample profit, without end, I should crown the venture both which you have begun, and which you shall begin; and as you wish me to delight you and all yours with joyous news—these tidings will I bring, that I may announce them to you, things which in especial are for your common interest 11 (for already do you know, indeed, that it has been given and assigned to me by the other Divinities, to preside over news and profit):

as you would wish me to favour and promote these things, that lasting gain may ever be forthcoming for you, 15 so shall you give silence for this play, and so shall you be fair and upright judges here, all of you. Now, by whose command, and for what reason I am come, I'll tell you, and at the sane time, myself, I will disclose my name. By the command of Jupiter I am come; my name is Mercury. 20 My father has sent me hither to you to entreat, although, what should as his commands be enjoined on you, he knew that you would do, inasmuch as he knew full well that you venerate and fear himself, as is befitting Jupiter. 24 But, certainly, he bade me ask this of you with entreaty, in gentle tones, and in bland accents. For, in fact, this Jupiter, by whose command I am come, dreads a mishap not less than any one of you. Born of a mortal mother, a mortal sire, it is not reasonable to be surprised if he has apprehensions for himself. 30 And I too, as well, who am the son of Jupiter, through my relationship to my father, stand in dread of ill. Therefore, in peace am I come to you, and peace do I bring. I wish a thing to be asked of you that's reasonable and feasible; for, reasonable things to ask of the reasonable, a reasonable mediator have I been sent. 35 For from the reasonable it is not right to ask things unreasonable; whereas from the unreasonable to ask things reasonable, is sheer folly, since these unrighteous persons are ignorant of what is right, and observe it not. Now then, all lend your attention here to the things which I shall say. What we wish, you ought to wish as well: 40 both I and my father have well deserved of you and of your state. But why should I mention how in Tragedies I have seen others, such as Neptune, Valour, Victory, Mars, Bellona, making mention of the good services which they had done you? Of all these benefits, the ruler of the Deities, my sire, was the founder. 46 But this has never been the habit of my father, to throw in your teeth what good he has done unto the good. He thinks that this is gratefully returned by you to him, and that he bestows these blessings on you deservedly, which he does bestow. 50 Now, the matter which I came here to ask, I'll first premise, after that I'll tell the subject of this Tragedy. Why have you contracted your brows? Is it because I said that this would be a Tragedy? I am a God, and I'll change it. This same, if you wish it, from a Tragedy I'll make to be 55 a Comedy, with all the lines the same. Whether would ye it were so, or not? But I'm too foolish; as though I didn't know, who am a God, that you so wish it; upon this subject I understand what your feelings are. I'll make this to be a mixture —a Tragi-comedy. 60 For me to make it entirely to be a Comedy, where Kings and Gods appear, I do not deem right. What then? Since here the servant has a part as well, just as I said, I'll make it to be a Tragi-comedy. Now Jupiter has ordered me to beg this of you, 65 that the inspectors should go among each of the seats throughout the whole theatre, amid the spectators, that, if they should see any suborned applauders of any actor, there should in the theatre be taken away from them the pledge of their coats, as a security for their good behaviour. 69 But if any should solicit the palm of victory for the actors, or if for any artist, whether by written letters, or whether any person himself should solicit personally, or whether by messenger; or if the Aediles, too, should unfairly adjudge to any one the reward; Jupiter has commanded the law to be the same as if he had sought by solicitation an appointment for himself or for another. 75 By valour has he declared that you exist as victors, not by canvassing or unfair dealing. Why any the less should there be the same principle for the player, which there is for the greatest man? By merit, not by favourers, ought we to seek our ends. He who does aright has ever favourers enough, if there is honesty in them in whose disposal this matter rests. 81 This, too, he directed me likewise in his injunctions, that there should be inspectors over the players; that, he who should have procured suborned persons to applaud himself, or he who should have contrived for another give less satisfaction, 85 from the same they might strip off his dress and leather mask. I don't wish you to be surprised, for what reason Jupiter now concerns himself about actors. Don't be surprised, Jupiter himself is about to take part in this play. Why are you wondering at this? As though, indeed, a new thing were now mentioned, that Jupiter takes

to the calling of a player. 91 But a year since, when here on the stage the actors invoked Jupiter, he came; he aided them. Besides, surely in Tragedy he has a place. This play, I say, Jupiter himself will take a part in this day, 95 and I together with him. Now do you give attention while I shall relate to you the subject of this Comedy. 97 This city is Thebes; in that house there (pointing), Amphitryon dwells, born at Argos, of an Argive sire; whose wife is Alcmena, daughter of Electryon. 100 This Amphitrvon is now the general of the Theban troops; for between the Teleboans and the Theban people there is war. He, before he departed hence for the expedition, left his wife Alcmena pregnant. But I believe that you already know how my father is disposed how free in these affairs he has been, 105 and how great a lover of many a woman, if any object once has captivated him. Unknown to her husband, he began to love Alcmena, and took temporary possession of her person for himself, and made her pregnant, too, by his embrace. 110 Now, that more fully you may understand the matter with respect to Alcmena, she is pregnant by both; both by her husband and by supreme Jupiter And my father is now lying here (he points to the house) in-doors with her; and for this reason is this night made longer, while he is taking this pleasure with her whom he desires. 115 But he has so disguised himself, as though he were Amphitryon. Now, that you may not be surprised at this dress of mine, inasmuch as I have come out here this way in servile garb, an ancient and an antique circumstance, made new, will I relate to you, by reason of which I have come to you attired in this new fashion; 120 for lo! my father Jupiter, now in the house, changes himself into the likeness of Amphitryon, and all the servants who see him think it is he, so shifting in his shape does he render himself when he chooses. I have taken on myself the form of the servant Sosia, 125 who has gone hence together with Amphitryon on the expedition, that I may be able to serve my father in his amour, and that the servants may not be enquiring who I am, when they see me here frequenting oft the house. Now, as they will suppose me a servant and their fellow-servant, 130 not any one will enquire who I am, or why I’m come. My father, now in-doors, is gratifying his inclination, and is embracing her of whom he is especially enamoured. What has been done there at the army, my father is now relating to Alcmena. She, who really is with a paramour, thinks that he is her own husband. There, my father is now 136 relating how he has routed the legions of the enemy; how he has been enriched with abundant gifts. Those gifts which there were given to Amphitryon, we have carried off; what he pleases, my father easily performs. 140 Now will Amphitryon come hither this day from the army, his servant too, whose form I am bearing. Now, that you may be able the more easily to distinguish between us, I always shall carry these little wings here (pointing) upon my broad-brimmed cap; then besides, for my father there will be a golden tuft 145 beneath his cap; that mark will not be upon Amphitryon. These marks no one of these domestics will be able to see; but you will see them. But yonder is Sosia, the servant of Amphitryon; he is now coming yonder from the harbour, with a lantern. 150 I will now drive him, as he arrives, away from the house. Attend, it will be worth the while of you spectators, for Jupiter and Mercury to perform here the actors’ part.

prologue.pr.31

31 contagione mei patris metuo malum.
32 propterea pace advenio et pacem ad vos affero:†
33 iustam rem et facilem esse oratam a vobis volo,
34 nam iusta ab iustis iustus sum orator datus.
35 nam iniusta ab iustis impetrari non decet,
36 iusta autem ab iniustis petere insipientia est;
37 quippe illi iniqui ius ignorant neque tenent.
38 nunc iam huc animum omnes quae loquar advortite.
39 debetis velle quae velimus: meruimus

et ego et pater de vobis et re publica;
nam quid ego memorem (ut alios in tragoediis
vidi, Neptunum Virtutem Victoriam
Martem Bellonam, commemorare quae bona
vobis fecissent) quis bene factis meus pater,
deorum regnator architectus omnibus?
sed mos numquam illi fuit patri meo,†
ut exprobraret quod bonis faceret boni;
gratum arbitratur esse id a vobis sibi
meritoque vobis bona se facere quae facit.
Nunc quam rem oratum huc veni primum proloquar,
post argumentum huius eloquar tragoediae.
quid? contraxistis frontem, quia tragoediam
dixi futuram hanc? deus sum, commutavero.
eandem hánc, si voltis, faciam ex tragoedia
comoedia ut sit omnibus isdem vorsibus.
utrum sit an non voltis? sed ego stultior,
quasi nesciam vos velle, qui divos siem.
teneo quid animi vostri super hac re siet:
faciam ut commixta sit: sit tragicomoedia.
nam me perpetuo facere ut sit comoedia,

prologue.pr.61

reges quo veniant et di, non par arbitror.
quid igitur? quoniam hic servos quoque partes habet,
faciam sit, proinde ut dixi, tragicomoedia.
nunc hoc me orare a vobis iussit Iuppiter,
ut conquaestores singula in subsellia
eant per totam caveam spectatoribus,
si cui favitores delegatos viderint,
ut is in cavea pignus capiantur togae;
sive quí ambissint palmam histrionibus
sive cuíquam artifici, si per scriptas litteras
sive qui ípse ambissit seu per internuntium,
sive adeo aediles perfidiose cui duint,
sirempse legem iussit esse Iuppiter,
quasi mágistratum sibi alterive ambiverit.
virtute dixit vos victores vivere,
non ambitione neque perfidia: qui minus
eadem histrioni sit lex quae summo viro?
virtute ambire oportet, non favitoribus.
sat habet favitorum semper qui recte facit,
si illis fides est quibus est ea res in manu.
hoc quoque etiam mihi pater in mandatis dedit,
ut conquaestores fierent histrionibus:
qui sibi mandasset delegati ut plauderent
quive quo placeret alter fecisset minus,
eius órnamenta et corium uti conciderent.
mirari nolim vos, quapropter Iuppiter
nunc histriones curet; ne miremini:
ipse hanc acturust Iuppiter comoediam.

quid? admirati estis? quasi vero novom
nunc proferatur, Ióvem facere histrioniam;

prologue.pr.91

etiam, histriones anno cum in proscaenio hic
Iovem invocarunt, venit, auxilio is fuit.

hanc fabulam, inquam, hic Iuppiter hodie ipse aget,
et ego una cum illo. nunc vos animum advortite,
dum huius argumentum éloquar comoediae.
Haec urbs est Thebae. in illisce habitat aedibus
Amphitruo, natus Argis ex Argo patre,
quicum Alcumena est nupta, Electri filia.
is nunc Amphitruo praefectust legionibus,
nam cum Telobois bellum est Thebano poplo.
is prius quam hinc abiit ipsemet in exercitum,
gravidam Alcumenam úxorem fecit suam.
nam ego vos novisse credo iam ut sit páter meus,
quam liber harum rerum multarum siet
quantusque amator sit quod complacitum est semel.
is amare occepit Alcumenam clam virum
usuramque eius corporis cepit sibi,
et gravidam fecit is eam compressu suo.
nunc de Alcumena ut rem teneatis rectius,
utrimque est gravida, et ex viro et ex summo Iove.
et meus pater nunc intus hic cum illa cubat,
et haec ob eam rem nox est facta longior,
dum cum illa quacum volt voluptatem capit;
sed ita adsimulavit se, quasi Amphitruo siet.
nunc ne hunc ornatum vos meum admiremini,
quod ego huc processi sic cum servili schema:
veterem atque antiquam rem novam ad vos proferam,
propterea ornatus in novom incessi modum.
nam méus pater intus núnc est eccum Iuppiter;

prologue.pr.121

in Amphitruonis vertit sese imaginem
omnesque eum esse censent servi qui vident:
ita versipellem se facit quando lubet.
ego servi sumpsi Sosiae mi imaginem,
qui cum Amphitruone abiit hinc in exercitum,
ut praeservire amanti meo possem patri
atque ut ne, qui essem, familiares quaererent,
versari crebro hic cum viderent me domi;
nunc, cum esse credent servom et conservom suom,
haud quisquam quaeret qui siem aut quid venerim.
pater nunc intus suo animo morem gerit:
cubat complexus cuius cupiens maxime est;
quae illi ad legionem facta sunt memorat pater
meus Alcumenae: ílla illum censet virum

suom esse, quae cum moecho est. ibi nunc meus pater
memorat, legiones hostium ut fugaverit,
quo pacto sit donis donatus plurimis.
ea dona, quae illic Amphitruoni sunt data,
abstulimus: facile meus pater quod volt facit.
nunc hodie Amphitruo veniet huc ab exercitu
et servos, cuius ego hanc feró imaginem.
nunc internosse ut nos possitis facilius,
ego has habebo úsque in petaso pinnulas;
tum meo patri autem torulus inerit aureus
sub petaso: id signum Amphitruoni non erit.
ea signa nemo hórum familiarium
videre poterit: verum vos videbitis.
sed Amphitruonis illic est servos Sosia:
a portu illíc nunc cum lanterna ádvenit.
abigam iam ego illum advenientem ab aedibus.

prologue.pr.151

adeste: erit operae pretium híc spectantibus
Iovem et Mercurium facere hístrioniam.

1.1.153

Qui me álter est audácior homo aút qui confidéntior,
iuventútis mores qui sciam, qui hoc noctis solus ambulem?
quid faciam nunc, si tres viri me in carcerem compegerint?
inde crás quasi e promptaria cella depromar ad flagrum,
nec causam liceat dicere mihi, néque in ero quicquam auxili
nec quisquam sit quin me malo omnes esse dignum deputent.
159_160 íta quasi incudém me miserum hómines octo válidi caedant:
161_162 ita peregre adveniens hospitio publicitus accipiar.
haéc eri immodéstia
coegit, me qui hoc noctis a portu ingratiis excitavit.
nonne ídem hoc luci me míttere potuit?
opulénto homini hoc servitús dura est,
hoc mágis miser est divítis servos:
nóctesque diésque assiduó satis superque est
quód facto aut dícto adeost ópus, quietus ne sis.
ípse dominus díves, operis ét laboris expers,
quódcumque homini áccidit libére, posse retur:
aéquom esse putát, non reputát laboris quid sit.

ergo ín servitúte expetúnt multa iníqua:
habéndum et ferúndum hoc onúst cum labóre.
Satiúst me queri íllo modó servitútem:
hodié qui fuerim líber,
eúm nunc potívit patér servitútis,
hic qui verna natus est queritur.
Sum véro verna vérbero: num número mi in mentém fuit,
dis advenientem gratias pro meritis agere atque alloqui?
ne illi edepol si merito meo referre studeant gratiam,

183 aliquem hominem allegent qui mihi advenienti os occillet probe,
184 quoniam bene quae in me fecerunt ingrata ea habui atque inrita.
153 What other person is there more bold than I, or who more stout of heart, who know the humours of young men, and who am walking at this hour of night alone? 155 What shall I do, if now the officers of the watch should thrust me into prison. To-morrow shall I be dealt out from there, just as though from a store-closet, for a whipping; nor will it be allowed me to plead my cause, nor will there be a bit of aid from my master; nor will there be a person but that they will imagine, all of them, that I am deserving. 159_160 And so will eight sturdy fellows be thumping on wretched me just like an anvil; in this way, just come from foreign parts, I shall be received with hospitality by the public. The inconsiderateness of my master compels me to this, who has packed me off from the harbour at this time of night whether I would or no. 165 Couldn't he as well have sent me here by daylight? For this reason, is servitude to a man of high station a greater hardship; for this reason is the servant of a wealthy man the more wretched: both night and day, without ceasing, there is enough, and more than enough of work for him; for doing or for saying occasion is ever arising, so that you can't be at rest. 170 The master, abounding in servants, and free from labour himself; thinks that whatever he happens to choose, can be done; he thinks that just, and reckons not what the labour is; nor will he ever consider whether he commands a thing that's reasonable or unreasonable. Wherefore, in servitude many hardships do befall us; 175 in pain this burden must be borne and endured. 176 'Twere with better reason for me to complain of servitude after this fashion; I, who to-day was free, and whom my father is now employing as a slave: this fellow is complaining, who was born a slave. 180 Really I am a rascal beyond a doubt; for only this moment it has suggested itself to me, that on my arrival I should give thanks, and address the Gods for their kindnesses vouchsafed. For surely, by my troth, if they were only desirous to give me a return according to my deserts, they would commission some person on my arrival soundly to box my ears, since those kindnesses which they have done me I have held as worthless and of no value. 185 He does what people are not generally in the habit of doing, in knowing what his deserts are. 186 What I never expected, nor any one else of my townsmen, to befall him, that same has come to pass, for us to come home safe and sound. Victorious, the enemy conquered, the troops are returning home, this very mighty war brought to an end, and the enemy slain. 190 A city that has caused many a bitter death for the Theban people, that same has been conquered by the strength and valour of our soldiers, and taken by storm, under the command and conduct of my master Amphitryon in especial. With booty, territory, and glory, too, has he loaded his fellow-citizens, and for Creon, King of Thebes, has he firmly fixed his sway. 195 From the harbour he has sent me before him to his house that I may bear these tidings to his wife, how he has promoted the public good by his guidance, conduct, and command. This now will I consider, in what manner I shall address her, when I've arrived there. If I tell a falsehood. I shall be doing as I am accustomed after my usual wont; for when they were fighting with all their might, then with all my might I ran away. 200 But still I shall pretend as though I was present, and I'll tell her what I heard. But in what manner and with what expressions it is right for me to tell my story, I still wish first to consider here with myself. (He assumes an attitude of thought.) In these terms will I give this narrative. In the first place, when we arrived there, when first we made land, Amphitryon immediately made choice of the powerful men among the chieftains. 205 Those he despatched on the embassy, and bade them tell his mind to the Teleboans; that if without constraint and without warfare they should be ready to deliver up what was plundered and the plunderers, and if they should be ready to restore what they had carried off, he would immediately conduct the army homewards, that the Greeks would depart from their territory, and that he would grant peace and quietness to them: but if they should be otherwise disposed, and not concede the things which he demanded, 210 he, in

consequence, would attack their city with extreme violence and with his men. When the embassadors had repeated these things, which Amphitryon had enjoined, in order to the Teleboans, being men stout of heart, relying on their valour, and confident in their prowess, they rebuked our embassadors very rudely. They answered that they were able in warfare to protect themselves and theirs, and that at once they must lead the army with all haste out of their territories. 216 When the embassadors brought back this message, straightway Amphitryon drew out all his army from the encampment; on the other side, the Teleboans led forth their legions from the town, furnished with most gorgeous arms. After they had gone forth on either side in full array, 220 the soldiers were marshalled, the ranks were formed. We, after our manner and usage, drew up our legions; the enemy, too, drew up their legions facing us. Then either general went forth into the mid-space beyond the throng of the ranks, and they parleyed together. 225 It was agreed between them, that, which ever side should be conquered in that battle, they should surrender up their city, lands, altars, hearths. and theraselves. After that was done, the trumpets on either side gave the signal; the earth re-echoed, they raised a shout on either side. Each general, both upon this side and on that, offered vows to Jupiter, and then encouraged his troops. 231 Each man according to his ability does that which each one can and has the strength to do; he smites with his falchion; the weapons crash; the welkin bellows with the uproar of the men; of breaths and pantings a cloud is formed; men fall by wounds inflicted by men. 235 At length, as we desired, our troops conquered; the foe fell in numbers; ours, on the other hand, pressed on; firm in our strength, we were victorious. But still not one betook himself to flight, nor yet gave way at his post, but standing there he waged the combat. 240 Sooner than quit the spot, they parted with their lives; each, as he stood, lay there and kept his rank in death. When my master Amphitryon saw this, at once he ordered the cavalry on the right to charge. The cavalry obeyed directly; from the right wing, 245 with a tremendous shout, with brisk onset they rushed on; and rightfully did they slaughter and trample down the impious forces of the foe. 248 Not even one word of these has he yet uttered correctly; for I was there in the battle personally, and my father too, when it was fought. 250 The enemy betook themselves to flight. Then was new spirit added to our men, the Teleboans flying, with darts were their bodies filled, and Amphitryon himself, with his own hand, struck off the head of Pterelas their king. This battle was being fought there even from the morning till the evening. This do I the better remember for this reason; because on that day I went without my breakfast. 255 But night at last, by its interposing, cut short this combat. The next day, the chiefs came weeping from the city to us at the camp. With covered hands, they entreated us to pardon their offences; and they all surrendered rendered up themselves. and all things divine and human, their city and their children, into the possession and unto the disposal of the Theban people. 260 Lastly, by reason of his valour, a golden goblet was presented to my master Amphitryon, from which king Pterelas had been used to drink. These things I'll thus tell my mistress. I'll now proceed to obey my master's order and to betake me home. 263 Heyday! he's about to come this way; I'll go meet him; and I'll not permit this fellow at any time to-day to approach this house. 265 Since I have his form upon myself, I'm resolved to play the fellow off. And indeed, since I have taken upon me his figure and his station, it is right for me likewise to have actions and manners like to his. Therefore it befits me to be artful, crafty, very cunning, and by his own weapon, artfulness, to drive him from the door. 270 But what means this? He is looking up at the sky. I'll watch what scheme he's about. 271 Upon my faith, for sure, if there is aught besides that I believe, or know for certain, I do believe that this night the God of Night has gone to sleep drunk; for neither does the Wain move itself in any direction in the sky, nor does the Moon bestir herself anywhere from where she first arose;

1.1.185

Facit ille quod volgo haud solent, ut quid se sit dignum sciat.
Quod numquam opinatus fui neque alius quisquam civium
sibi eventurum, id contigit, ut salvi poteremur domi.
victores victis hostibus legiones reveniunt domum,
duelló exstincto maximo atque internecatis hostibus.
quod multa Thebano poplo acerba obiecit funera,
id vi et virtute militum victum atque expugnatum oppidum est
imperio atque auspicio eri mei Amphitruonis maxime.
praeda atque agro adoriaque adfecit populares suos
regique Thebano Creoni regnum stabilivit suom.
me a portu praemisit domum, ut haec nuntiem uxori suae,
ut gesserit rem publicam ductu imperio auspicio suo.
ea nunc meditabor quo modo illi dicam, cum illo advenero.
si dixero mendacium, solens meo more fecero.
nam cum pugnabant maxume, ego tum fugiebam maxume;
verum quasi adfuerim tamen simulabo atque audita eloquar.
sed quo modo et verbis quibus me deceat fabularier,
prius ipse mecum etiam volo hic meditari. sic hoc proloquar.
Principio ut illo advenimus, ubi primum terram tetigimus,
continuo Amphitruo delegit viros primorum principes;
eos legat, Telobois iubet sententiam ut dicant suam:
si sine vi et sine bello velint rapta et raptores tradere,
si quae asportassent redderent, se exercitum extemplo domum
reducturum, abituros agro Argivos, pacem atque otium
dare illis; sin aliter sient animati neque dent quae petat,
sese igitur summa vi virisque eorum oppidum oppugnassere.
haec ubi Telobois ordine iterarunt quos praefecerat
Amphitruo, magnanimi viri freti virtute et viribus
superbe nimis ferociter legatos nostros increpant,
respondent bello se et suos tutari posse, proinde uti

1.1.215

propere irent, de suis finibus exercitus deducerent.
haec ubi legati pertulere, Amphitruo castris ilico
producit omnem exercitum. Teloboae contra ex oppido
legiones educunt suas nimis pulcris armis praeditas.
póstquam utrimque éxitum est máxima cópia,
dispertiti viri, dispertiti ordines,
nos nostras more nostro et modo instruximus
légiones, item hóstes contra légiones suas ínstruont.
deínde utrique ímperatóres in medium éxeunt,
éxtra turbam órdinum cólloquontúr simul.
convenit, victi utri sint eo proelio,
urbem agrum aras focos seque uti dederent.
postquam id actum est, tubae contra utrimque occanunt,
consonat terra, clamorem utrimque efferunt.
imperator utrimque, hinc et illinc, Iovi
vota suscipere, utrimque hortari exercitum.
tum pro se quisque id quod quisque potest et valet
edit, ferro ferit, tela frangunt, boat

caélum fremitú virum, ex spíritu atque anhélitu
nébula constát, cadunt vólnerum ví viri.
denique, ut voluimus, nostra superat manus:
hostes crebri cadunt, nostri contra ingruont
ví feroces.
sed †fugam in se tamen nemo convortitur
nec recedit loco quin statim rem gerat;
animam omittunt prius quam loco demigrent:
quisque ut steterat iacet optinetque ordinem.
hóc ubi Amphítruo erus cónspicatust,
ílico equités iubet déxtera indúcere.
equites parent citi: ab dextera maximo

1.1.245

cúm clamore involant ímpetu alacri,
foédant et próterunt hóstium cópias
iúre iniustas.
Numquam étiam quicquam adhúc verborum est prólocutus pérperam:
namque ego fui illi in re praesenti et meus, cum pugnatum est, pater.
Perduelles penetrant se in fugam; ibi nostris animus additust:
vortentibus Telobois telis complebantur corpora,
ipsusque Amphitruo regem Pterelam sua obtruncavit manu.
haec illic est pugnata pugna úsque a mani ad vesperum
(hoc adeo hoc commemini magis, quia illo die inpransus fui),
sed proelium id tandem diremit nox interventu suo.
postridie in castra ex urbe ad nos veniunt flentes principes:
velatis manibus orant ignoscamus peccatum suom,
deduntque se, divina humanaque omnia, urbem et liberos
in dicionem atque in arbitratum cuncti Thebano poplo.
post ob virtutem ero Amphitruoni patera donata aurea est,
qui Pterela potitare solitus est rex. haec sic dicam erae.
nunc pergam eri imperium exequi et me domum capessere.
Áttat, illic húc iturust. íbo ego illi óbviam,
neque ego huc hominem hodie ad aedis has sinam umquam accedere;
quando imago est huius in me, certum est hominem eludere.
et enim vero quoniam formam cépi huius ín med et statum,
decet et facta moresque huius habere me similes item.
itaque me malum esse oportet, callidum, astutum admodum
atque hunc, telo suo sibi, malitia a foribus pellere.
sed quid illúc est? caelum aspectat. observabo quam rem agat.
Certe edepol, si quicquamst aliud quod credam aut certo sciam,
credo ego hac noctu Nocturnum óbdormivisse ebrium.
nam neque se Septentriones quoquam in caelo commovent,
neque se Luna quoquam mutat atque uti exorta est semel,

1.1.275

nec Iugulae neque Vesperugo neque Vergiliae óccidunt.
ita statim stant signa, neque nox quoquam concedit die.
Perge, Nox, ut occepisti, gere patri morem meo:
optumo optume optumam operam das, datam pulchre locas.

279 Neque ego hac nocte longiorem me vidisse censeo,
280 nisi item unam, verberatus quam pependi perpetem;
281 eam quoque edepol etiam multo haec vicit longitudine.
282 credo edepol equidem dormire Solem, atque adpotum probe;
283 mira sunt nisi invitavit sese in cena plusculum.
284 Ain vero, verbero? deos esse tui similis putas?
285 ego pol te istis tuis pro dictis et male factis, furcifer,
286 accipiam; modo sis veni huc: invenies infortunium.
287 Vbi sunt isti scortatores, qui soli inviti cubant?
288 haec nox scita est exercendo scorto conducto male.
289 Meus pater nunc pro huius verbis recte et sapienter facit,
290 qui complexus cum Alcumena cubat amans animo obsequens.
291 Ibo ut erus quod imperavit Alcumenae nuntiem.
292 sed quis hic ést homo, quem ante aedis video hoc noctis? non placet.
293 Nullust hoc metuculosus aeque.
293b Mi in mentem venit,
294 illic homó hoc dé umero volt pallium detexere.
295 Timet homo: deludam ego illum.
295b Perii, dentes pruriunt;
296 certe advenientem hic me hospitio pugneo accepturus est.
297 credo misericors est: nunc propterea quod me meus erus
298 fecit ut vigilarem, hic pugnis faciet hodie ut dormiam.
299 oppido interii. obsecro hercle, quantus et quam validus est.
300 Clare advorsum fabulabor, ut hic auscultet quae loquar;
301 igitur magis demum maiorem in sese concipiet metum.
302 agite, pugni, iam diu est quom ventri victum non datis:

275 nor does Orion, or the Evening Star, or the Pleiades, set. In such a fashion are the stars standing stock-still, and the night is yielding not a jot to the day. 277 Go on, Night, as you've begun, and pay obedience to my father. In best style, the best of services are you performing for the best of beings; in giving this, you reap a fair return. 279 I do not think that I have ever seen a longer night than this, 280 except one of like fashion, which livelong night I was hanging up, having been first whipped. Even that as well, by my troth, does this one by far exceed in its length. I' faith, I really do believe that the Sun's asleep, and is thoroughly drenched. It's a wonder to me if he hasn't indulged himself a little too much at dinner. 284 Do you really say so, you scoundrel? Do you think that the Gods are like yourself? 285 I' faith, you hang-dog, I'll entertain you for these speeches and misdeeds of yours; only come this way, will you, and you'll find your ruin. 287 Where are those wenchers, who unwillingly lie a-bed alone? A rare night this for making the best of what was a bad bargain at first. 289 My father then, according to this fellow's words, is doing rightly and wisely, who in his amorousness, indulging his passion, is lying in the embraces of Alcmena. 291 I'll go tell Alcmena, as my master ordered me. (Advancing, he discovers MERCURY.) But who is this fellow that I see before the house at this time of night? I don't like it. 293 There is not in existence another such cowardly fellow as this. 293b Now, when I think of it, this fellow wishes to take my mantle off once more. 295 The fellow's afraid; I'll have some sport with him. 295b I'm quite undone, my teeth are chattering. For sure, on my arrival, he is about to receive me with the hospitality of his fist. He's a merciful person, I suppose; now, because my master has obliged me to keep awake, with his fists just now he'll be making me go to sleep. I'm most confoundedly undone. Troth now, prithee, look, how big and how strong he is. 300 I'll talk at him aloud, he shall hear what I say. Therefore indeed, in a still greater degree, shall he conceive fears within himself. (In a loud voice, holding up his fists.) Come, fists, it's a long time now since you found provision for my

stomach; it seems to have taken place quite a long time ago, when yesterday you laid four men asleep, stript naked. 304b I’m dreadfully afraid 305 lest I should be changing my name here, and become a Quintus instead of a Sosia. He declares that he has laid four men asleep; I fear lest I should be adding to that number. 307b Well, now then for it. This is the way I intend. 308 He is girded tight; for sure, he’s getting himself ready. 308b He shan’t get off without getting a thrashing. 309 What person, I wonder? 309b Beyond a doubt, whatever person comes this way, he shall eat my fists. 310 Get out with you, I don’t wish to eat at this time of night; I’ve lately dined. Therefore do you, if you are wise, bestow your dinner on those who are hungry. 312 The weight of this fist is no poor one. 312b I’m done for; he is poising his fists. 313 What if I were to touch him, stroking him down , so that he may go to sleep? 313b You would be proving my salvation; for I’ve been watching most confoundedly these three nights running . 314b My hand refuses to learn to strike his cheek; it cannot do a disgraceful action. 316 Hand of mine, of a changed form must he become whom you smite with this fist. 317 This fellow will be furbishing me up, and be moulding my face anew. 318 The man that you hit full, his face must surely be boned.

1.1.303

303 iam pridem videtur factum, heri quod homines quattuor
304 in soporem collocastis nudos.
304b Formido male,
305 né ego hic nomen meum commutem et Quintus fiam e Sosia;
306 quattuor nudos sopori se dedisse hic autumat:
307 metuo ne numerum augeam illum.
307b em, nunciam ergo: sic volo.
308 Cingitur: certe expedit se.
308b Non feret quin vapulet.
309 Quis homo?
309b Quisquis homo huc profecto venerit, pugnos edet.
310 Apage, non placet me hoc noctis esse: cenavi modo;
311 proin tu istam cenam largire, si sapis, esurientibus.
312 Haud malum huic est pondus pugno.
312b Perii, pugnos ponderat.
313 Quid si ego illum tractim tangam, ut dormiat?
313b Servaveris,
314 nam continuas has tris noctes pervigilavi.
314b Pessumest,
315 facimus nequiter, ferire malam male discit manus;
316 alia forma ésse oportet quem tu pugno legeris.
317 Illic homo me interpolabit meumque os finget denuo.
318 Exossatum os esse oportet quem probe percusseris.
319 Mirum ni hic me quasi murenam éxossare cogitat.
320 ultro istunc qui exossat homines. perii, si me aspexerit.
321 Olet homo quidam malo suo.
321b ei, numnam ego óbolui?
322 Atque haud longe abesse oportet, verum longe hinc afuit.
323 Illic homo superstitiosust.
323b Gestiunt pugni mihi.
319 It’s a wonder if this fellow isn’t thinking of boning me just like a lamprey. Away with a fellow that bones people! If he sees me, I’m a dead man. 321 Some fellow is stinking to his destruction. 321b Woe to me! Is it I that stink? 322 And he cannot be very far off; but he has been a long way off from here. 323 This person’s a wizard . 323b My fists are longing.

324 If you are going to exercise them upon me, I beg that you'll first cool them down against the wall. 325 A voice has come flying to my ears. 325b Unlucky fellow, for sure, was I, who didn't clip its wings. I've got a voice with wings, it seems. 327 This fellow is demanding of me for himself a heavy punishment for his beast's back. 328 As for me, I've got no beast's back. 328b He must be well loaded with my fists. 329 I' faith, I'm fatigued, coming from board ship, when I was brought hither; even now I'm sea-sick. 330 Without a burden, I can hardly creep along, so don't think that with a load I can go. 331 Why, surely, somebody is speaking here. 331b I'm all right, he doesn't see me; he thinks it's Somebody speaking: Sosia is certainly my name. 333 But here, from the right-hand side, the voice, as it seems, strikes upon my ear. 334 I'm afraid that I shall be getting a thrashing here this day, in place of my voice, that's striking him. 335 Here he is—he's coming towards me, most opportunely. 335b I'm terrified—I'm numbed all over. Upon my faith, I don't know where in the world I now am, if any one should ask me; and to my misfortune, I cannot move myself for fright. It's all up with me; the orders of his master and Sosia are lost together. But I'm determined boldly to address this fellow to his face, 340 so that I may be able to appear valiant to him; that he may keep his hands off me. 341 Where are you going, you that are carrying Vulcan enclosed in your horn? 342 Why do you make that enquiry, you who are boning men's heads with your fists? 343 Are you slave or free man? 343b Just as it suits my inclination. 344 Do you really say so? 344b I really do say so. 344c Whip-scoundrel! 344d Now you are telling a lie. 345 But I'll soon make you own that I'm telling the truth.

1.1.324

324 Si in me exercituru's exerciturus es , quaeso in parietem ut primum domes.
325 Vox mi ad aures advolavit.
325b Né ego homo infelix fui,
326 qui non alas intervelli: volucrem vocem gestito.
327 Illic homo a me sibi malam rem arcessit iumento suo.
328 Non equidem ullum habeo iumentum.
328b Onerandus est pugnis probe.
329 Lassus sum hercle, navi ut vectus huc sum: etiam nunc nauseo;
330 vix incedo inanis, ne ire posse cum onere existimes.
331 Certe enim hic nescio quis loquitur.
331b Salvos sum, non me videt:
332 nescioquem loqui autumat; mihi certo nomen Sosiaest.
333 Hinc enim míhi dextra vox auris, ut videtur, verberat.
334 Metuo, vocis ne vicem hodie hic vapulem, quae hunc verberat.
335 Optume eccum incedit ad me.
335b Timeo, totus torpeo.
336 non edepol nunc ubi terrarum sim scio, si quis roget,
337 neque miser me commovere possum prae formidine.
338 ilicet, mandata eri perierunt una et Sosia.
339 verum certum est confidenter hominem contra conloqui,
340 qui possim videri huic fortis, a me ut abstineat manum.
341 Quo ambulas tu, qui Volcanum in cornu conclusum geris?
342 Quid id exquiris tu, qui pugnis os exossas hominibus?
343 Servosne es an liber?
343b Vtcumque animo conlibitum est meo.
344 Ain vero?
344b Aio enim vero.
344c Verbero.

344d Mentiris nunc.
345 At iam faciam ut verum dicas dicere.
345b What necessity is there for it? 346 Can I know whence you have set out, whose you are, or why you are come? 347 This way I’m going, and I’m the servant of my master. Are you any the wiser now? 348 I’ll this day make you be holding that foul tongue of yours. 348b You can’t; it is kept pure and becomingly. 349b Do you persist in chattering? 350 What business now have you at this house? 350b Aye, and what business have you? 351 King Creon always sets a watch every night. 352 He does right; because we were abroad, he has been protecting our house. But however, do go in now, and say that some of the family servants have arrived. 354 How far you are one of the family servants I don’t know. But unless you are off from here this instant, 355 family servant as you are, I’ll make you to be received in no familiar style. 356 Here, I say, I live, and of these people I am the servant. 356b But do you understand how it is? Unless you are off, I’ll make you to be exalted this day. 357b In what way, pray? 358 You shall be carried off, you shan’t walk away, if I take up a stick. 359 But I declare that I am one of the domestics of this family. 360 Consider, will you, how soon you want a drubbing, unless you are off from here this instant. 361 Do you want, as I arrive from foreign parts, to drive me from my home? 362 Is this your home? 362b It is so, I say. 362c Who is your master, then? 363 Amphitryon, who is now the general of the Theban forces, to whom Alcmena is married. 364b How say you? What’s your name? 365 The Thebans call me Sosia, the son of my father Davus. 366 Assuredly, at your peril have you come here this day, with your trumped-up lies, your patched-up knaveries, you essence of effrontery. 368 Why no, it’s rather with garments patched-up that I’m arrived here, not with knaveries. 369 Why, you are lying again; you come with your feet, surely, and not with your garments. 370 Yes, certainly. 370b Then certainly take that for your lie.

1.1.345b

345b Quid eo est opus?
346 Possum scire, quo profectus, cuius sis aut quid veneris?
347 Húc eo, eri iussu, eius sum servos. numquid nunc es certior?
348 Ego tibi istam hodie, sceleste, comprimam linguam.
348b Haud potes:
349 bene pudiceque adservatur.
349b Pergin argutarier?
350 quid apud hasce aedis negoti ést tibi?
350b Immo quid tibi est?
351 Rex Creo vigiles nocturnos singulos semper locat.
352 Bene facit: quia nos eramus peregre, tutatust domi;
353 at nunc abi sane, advenisse familiares dicito.
354 Nescio quam tu familiaris sis: nisi actutum hinc abis,
355 familiaris accipiere faxo haud familiariter.
356 Hic inquam habito ego atque horunc servos sum.
356b At scin quo modo?
357 faciam ego hodie te superbum, nisi hinc abis.
357b Quonam modo?
358 Auferere, non abibis, sí ego fustem sumpsero.
359 Quin me esse huius familiai familiarem praedico.
360 Vide sis quam mox vapulare vis, nisi actutum hinc abis.
361 Tun domo prohibere peregre me advenientem postulas?
362 Haecine tua domust?
362b Ita inquam.
362c Quis erus est igitur tibi?

363 Amphitruo, qui nunc praefectust Thebanis legionibus,
364 quicum nupta est Alcumena.
364b Quid ais? quid nomen tibi est?
365 Sosiam vocant Thebani, Davo prognatum patre.
366 Ne tu istic hodie malo tuo compositis mendaciis

1.1.367

367 advenisti, audaciai columen, consutis dolis.
368 Immo equidem tunicis consutis huc advenio, non dolis.
369 At mentiris etiam: certo pedibus, non tunicis venis.
370 Ita profecto.
370b Nunc profecto vapula ob mendacium.
371 Non edepol volo profecto.
371b At pol profecto ingratiis.
372 hoc quidem profecto certum est, non est arbitrarium.
373 Tuam fidem obsecro.
373b Tun te audes Sosiam esse dicere,
374 quí ego sum?
374b Perii.
374c Parum etiam, praeut futurum est, praedicas.
375 quoius nunc es?
375b Tuos, nam pugnis usu fecisti tuom.
376 pro fidem, Thebani cives.
376b Etiam clamas, carnifex?
377 loquere, quid venisti?
377b Vt esset quem tu pugnis caederes.
378 Cuius es?
378b Amphitruonis, inquam, Sosia.
378c Ergo istoc magis,
379 quia vaniloquo's vaniloquus es , vapulabis: ego sum, non tu, Sosia.
380 Ita di faciant, ut tu potius sis atque ego te ut verberem.
381 Etiam muttis?
381b Iam tacebo.
381c Quis tibi erust?
381d Quem tu voles.
382 Quid igitur? qui nunc vocare?
382b Nemo nisi quem iusseris.
371 By my troth, I certainly don’t wish for it of course. 371b But by my faith, you certainly shall have it of course, whether you wish or not: for, in fact, this is certainly my determination, and it is not at your own option. 373 Mercy, I entreat of you. 373b Do you dare to say that you are Sosia, when I myself am he? 374b I’m being murdered. 374c Why, you are crying out for a trifle as yet, compared with what it will be. 375 Whose are you now? 375b Your own; for with your fists you have laid hands on me. Help, help, citizens of Thebes. 376b What, still bawling, you scoundrel? Speak—what have you come for? 377b For there to be somebody for you to belabour with your fists. 378 Whose are you? 378b Amphitryon’s Sosia, I tell you. 378c For this reason then you shall be beaten the more, because you prate thus idly; I am Sosia, not you. 380 I wish the Gods would have it so, that you were he in preference, and that I were thrashing you. 381 What, muttering still? 381b I’ll hold my tongue then. 381c Who is your master? 381d Whoever you like. 382 How then? What’s your name now? 382b Nothing but what you shall command. 383 You said that you were Amphitryon’s Sosia. 383b I made a mistake; but this I meant to say, that I was

Amphitryon’s associate . 385 Why, I was sure that we had no servant called Sosia except myself. Your senses are forsaking you. 386b I wish that those fists of yours had done so. 387 I am that Sosia, whom you were just now telling me that you are. 388 I pray that I may be allowed to discourse with you in quietness, so as not to be beaten. 389 Well then, let there be a truce for a short time, if you want to say anything. 390 I’ll not speak unless peace is concluded, since you are the stronger with your fists. 391 If you wish to say anything, speak; I’ll not hurt you. 391b Am I to trust in your word?

1.1.383

383 Amphitruonis te esse aiebas Sosiam.
383b Peccaveram,
384 nam Amphitruonis †socium ne me esse volui dicere.
385 Scibam equidem nullum esse nobis nisi me servom Sosiam.
386 fugit te ratió.
386b Vtinam istuc pugni fecissent tui.
387 Ego sum Sosia ille quem tu dudum esse aiebas mihi.
388 Obsecro ut per pacem liceat te alloqui, ut ne vapulem.
389 Immo indutiae parumper fiant, si quid vis loqui.
390 Non loquar nisi pace facta, quando pugnis plus vales.
391 Dic si quid vis, non nocebo.
391b Tuae fide credo?
391c Meae.
392 Quid si falles?
392b Tum Mercurius Sosiae iratus siet.
393 Animum advorte. nunc licet mihi libere quidvis loqui.
394 Amphitruonis ego sum servos Sosia.
394b Etiam denuo?
395 Pacem feci, foedus feci. vera dico.
395b Vapula.
396 Vt libet quid tibi libet fac, quoniam pugnis plus vales;
397 verum, utut es facturus, hoc quidem hercle haud reticebo tamen.
398 Tu me vivos hodie numquam facies quin sim Sosia.
399 Certe edepol tu me alienabis numquam quin noster siem;
400 nec nobis praeter med alius quisquam est servos Sosia.
401
402 Hic homo sanus non est.
402b Quod mihi praedicas vitium, id tibi est.
403 quid, malum, non súm ego servos Amphitruonis Sosia?
404 nonne hac noctu nostra navis huc ex portu Persico

391c Yes, in my word. 392 What, if you deceive me? 392b Why, then may Mercury be angry with Sosia . 393 Then give attention: now I’m at liberty to say in freedom anything I please. I am Sosia, servant of Amphitryon. 394b What, again? 395 I have concluded the peace, ratified the treaty—I speak the truth. 395b Take that, then. 396 As you please, and what you please, pray do, since you are the stronger with your fists. But whatever you shall do, still, upon my faith, I really shall not be silent about that. 398 So long as you live, you shall never make me to be any other than Sosia at this moment. 399 I’ faith, you certainly shall never make me to be any other person than my own self; 400 and besides myself we have no other servant of the name of Sosia—myself, who went hence on the expedition together with Amphitryon. 402 This fellow is not in his senses. 402b The malady that you impute to me, you have that same yourself. How, the plague, am I not Sosia, the servant of Amphitryon? Has not our ship, which brought me, arrived here this night from the Persian

port? 405 Has not my master sent me here? Am I not now standing before our house? Have I not a lantern in my hand? Am I not talking? Am I not wide awake? Has not this fellow been thumping me with his fists? By my troth , he has been doing so; for even now, to my pain, my cheeks are tingling. Why, then, do I hesitate? Or why don’t I go in-doors into our house? 410 How—your house? 410b Indeed it really is so. 410c Why, all that you have been saying just now, you have trumped up; I surely am Amphitryon’s Sosia. For in the night this ship of ours weighed anchor from the Persian port, and where king Pterelas reigned, the city we took by storm, and the legions of the Teleboans in fighting we took by arms, 415 and Amphitryon himself cut off the head of king Pterelas in battle. 416 I do not trust my own self, when I hear him affirm these things; certainly, he really does relate exactly the things that were done there. (Aloud.) But how say you? What spoil from the Teleboans was made a present to Amphitryon? 419 A golden goblet, from which king Pterelas used to drink. 420 He has said the truth. Where now is this goblet? 420b ’Tis in a casket, sealed with the seal of Amphitryon. 421b Tell me, what is the seal? 422 The Sun rising with his chariot. Why are you on the catch for me, you villain? 423 He has overpowered me with his proofs. I must look out for another name. I don’t know from whence he witnessed these things. I’ll now entrap him finely; 425 for what I did alone by myself, and when not another person was present in the tent, that, he certainly will never be able this day to tell me. (Aloud.) If you are Sosia, when the armies were fighting most vigorously, what were you doing in the tent? If you tell me that, I’m vanquished. 429 There was a cask of wine; from it I filled an earthen pot . 429b He has got upon the track. 430 That I drew full of pure wine, just as it was born from the mother grape. 431 It’s a wonder if this fellow wasn’t lying hid inside of that earthen pot. It is the fact, that there I did drink an earthen pot full of wine.

1.1.405

405 venit, quae me advexit? nonne me huc erus misit meus?
406 nonne ego nunc sto ante aedes nostras? non mi est lanterna in manu?
407 non loquor, nón vigilo? nonne hic homo módo me pugnis contudit?
408 fecit hercle, nam etiam misero nunc mihi malae dolent.
409 quid igitur ego dubito, aut cur non intro eo in nostram domum?
410 Quid, domum vostram?
410b Ita enim vero.
410c Quin quae dixisti modo
411 omnia ementitu's ementitus es : equidem Sosia Amphitruonis sum.
412 nam noctu hac soluta est navis nostra e portu Persico,
413 et ubi Pterela rex regnavit oppidum expugnavimus,
414 et legiones Teloboarum vi pugnando cepimus,
415 et ipsus Amphitruo optruncavit regem Pterelam in proelio.
416 Egomet mihi non credo, cum illaec autumare illum audio;
417 hic quidem cérte quae illic sunt res gestae memorat memoriter.
418 sed quid ais? quid Amphitruoni doni a Telobois datum est?
419 Pterela rex qui potitare solitus est patera aurea.
420 Elocutus est. ubi patera nunc est?
420b Est in cistula;
421 Amphitruonis obsignata signo est.
421b Signi dic quid est?
422 Cum quadrigis Sol exoriens. quid me captas, carnufex?
423 Argumentis vicit, aliud nomen quaerundum est mihi.
424 nescio unde haec hic spectavit. iám ego hunc decipiam probe;
425 nam quod egomet solus feci, nec quisquam alius affuit,
426 in tabernaclo, id quidem hodie numquam poterit dicere.

427 si tu Sosia es, legiones cum pugnabant maxume,
428 quid in tabernaclo fecisti? victus sum, si dixeris.
429 Cadus erat vini, inde implevi hírneam.
429b Ingressust viam.

1.1.430

430 Eam ego, ut matre fuerat natum, vini éduxi meri.
431 Factum est illud, ut ego illíc vini hirneam ebiberim meri.
432 mira sunt nisi latuit intus illic in illac hirnea.
433 Quid nunc? vincon argumentis, te non esse Sosiam?
434 Tu negas med esse?
434b Quid ego ni negem, qui egomet siem?
435 Per Iovem iuro med esse neque me falsum dicere.
436 At ego per Mercurium iuro, tibi Iovem non credere;
437 nam iniurato scio plus credet mihi quam iurato tibi.
438 Quis ego sum saltem, si non sum Sosia? te interrogo.
439 Vbi ego Sosia nolim esse, tu esto sane Sosia;
440 nunc, quando ego sum, vapulabis, ni hinc abis, ignobilis.
441 Certe edepol, quom illum contemplo et formam cognosco meam,
442 quem ad modum ego sum (saepe in speculum inspexi), nimis similest mei;
443 itidem habet petasum ac vestitum: tam consimilest atque ego;
444 sura, pes, statura, tonsus, oculi, nasum vel labra,
445 malae, mentum, barba, collus: totus. quid verbis opust?
446 si tergum cicatricosum, nihil hoc similist similius.
447 sed quom cogito, equidem certo idem sum qui semper fui.
448 novi erum, novi aedis nostras; sane sapio et sentio.
449 non ego illi obtempero quod loquitur. pultabo foris.
450 Quó agis te?
450b Domum.
450c Quadrigas si nunc inscendas Iovis
451 atque hinc fugias, ita vix poteris effugere infortunium.
452 Nonne erae meae nuntiare quod erus meus iussit licet?
453 Tuae si quid vis nuntiare: hanc nostram adire non sinam.
454 nam si me inritassis, hodie lumbifragium hinc auferes.
455 Abeo potius. di immortales, obsecro vostram fidem,
456 ubi ego perii? ubi immutatus sum? ubi ego formam perdidi?
433 Well—do I now convince you by my proofs that you are not Sosia? 434 Do you deny that I am? 434b Why should I not deny it, who am he myself? 435 By Jupiter I swear that I am he, and that I do not say false. 436 But by Mercury, I swear that Jupiter does not believe you; for I am sure that he will rather credit me without an oath than you with an oath. 438 Who am I, at all events, if I am not Sosia? I ask you that. 439 When I choose not to be Sosia, then do you be Sosia; now, since I am he, you'll get a thrashing, if you are not off hence, you fellow without a name. 441 Upon my faith, for sure, when I examine him and recollect my own figure, just in such manner as I am (I've often looked in a glass):, he is exactly like me. He has the broad-brimmed hat and clothing just the same; he is as like me as I am myself. His leg, foot, stature, shorn head, eyes, nose, even his lips, 445 cheeks, chin, beard, neck—the whole of him. What need is there of words? If his back is marked with scars, than this likeness there is nothing more like. But when I reflect, really, I surely am the same person that I always was. My master I know, I know our I house; I am quite in my wits and senses. I'm not going to I obey this fellow in what he says; I'll knock at the door. 450 Whither are you betaking yourself? 450b Home. 450c If now you were to ascend the chariot

of Jove and fly away from here, then you could hardly be able to escape destruction. 452 Mayn’t I be allowed to deliver the message to my mistress that my master ordered me to give? 453 If you want to deliver any message to your own mistress; this mistress of mine I shall not allow you to approach. But if you provoke me, you’ll be just now taking hence your loins broken. 455 In preference, I’ll be off. (Aside.) Immortal Gods, I do beseech your mercy. Where did I lose myself? Where have I been transformed? Where have I parted with my figure? Or have I left myself behind there, if perchance I have forgotten it? For really this person has possession of all my figure, such as it formerly was. While living, that is done for me, which no one will ever do for me when dead. 460 I’ll go to the harbour, and I’ll tell my master these things as they have happened—unless even he as well shall not know me, which may Jupiter grant, so that this day, bald, with shaven crown, I may assume the cap of freedom.

1.1.457

457 an egomet me illic reliqui, si forte oblitus fui?
458 nám hic quidem omnem imaginem meam, quae antehac fuerat, possidet.
459 vivo fit quod numquam quisquam mortuo faciet mihi.
460 ibo ad portum atque haec uti sunt facta ero dicam meo;
461 nisi etiam is quoque me ignorabit: quod ille faxit Iuppiter,
462 ut ego hodie ráso capite calvos capiam pilleum.—

1.2

463 Bene próspere hoc hodie operis processit mihi:
464 amovi a foribus maximam molestiam,
465 patri ut liceret tuto illam amplexarier.
466 iam ille illuc ad erum cum Amphitruonem advenerit,
467 narrabit servom hinc sese a foribus Sosiam
468 amovisse; ille adeo illum mentiri sibi
469 credet, neque credet huc profectum, ut iusserat.
470 erroris ambo ego illos et dementiae
471 complebo atque omnem Amphitruonis familiam,
472 adeo usque, satietatem dum capiet pater
473 illius quám amat. igitur demum omnes scient
474 quae facta. denique Alcumenam Iuppiter
475 redigét antiquam coniugi in concordiam.
476 nam Amphitruo actutum uxori turbas conciet
477 atque insimulabit eam probri; tum meus pater
478 eam séditionem illi in tranquillum conferet.
479 nunc de Alcumena dudum quod dixi minus,
480 hodie illa pariet filios geminos duos
481 alter decumo post mense nascetur puer
482 quam seminatust, alter mense septumo;
483 eorum Ámphitruonis alter est, alter Iovis:
484 verum minori puero maior est pater,
485 minor maiori. iamne hoc scitis quid siet?
486 sed Alcumenae huius honoris gratia
487 pater curavit uno ut fetu fieret,
488 uno ut labore absolvat aerumnas duas.
489
490

491 quamquam, ut iam dudum dixi, resciscet tamen
492 Amphitruo rem omnem. quid igitur? nemo id probro
493 profecto ducet Alcumenae; nam deum
494 non par videtur facere, delictum suom
495 suamque ut culpam expetere in mortalem ut sinat.
496 orationem comprimam: crepuit foris.
497 Amphitruo subditivos eccum exit foras
498 cum Alcumena uxore usuraria.
463 Well and prosperously has this affair gone on for me; from the door have I removed the greatest obstacle, 465 so that it may be allowed my father to embrace her in security. When now he shall have reached his master, Amphitryon there, he will say that the servant Sosia has repulsed himself from the door here; and then the other will suppose that he is telling him a lie, and will not believe that he has come here as he had ordered him. 470 Both of them and the whole household of Amphitryon I will fill with mistakes and distraction, even until my father shall have had full enjoyment of her whom he loves; then at last all shall know what has been done. In the end Jupiter shall restore Alcmena 475 to the former affection of her husband. For Amphitryon will just now be beginning a quarrel with his wife, and will be accusing her of incontinence; then will my father change for her this strife into tranquillity. Now, inasmuch as yet I’ve said but little about Alcmena, 480 this day will she bring forth two sons, twins; the one will be born in the tenth month after he was begotten, the other in the seventh month; of these the one is the son of Amphitryon, the other of Jupiter. But of the younger son the father is the superior, 485 of the elder the inferior. (To the AUDIENCE.) Now do you comprehend this how it is? But for the sake of the honor of this Alcmena, my father will take care that it shall happen at one birth, so that in one travail she may complete her double pangs, and not be laid under suspicion of unchastity, 490 and that the clandestine connexion may remain concealed. Although, as I have said just now, Amphitryon shall still know all the matter in the end. What then? No one surely will impute it to Alcmena as a disgrace; for it does not seem that a God is acting justly 495 to permit his own offences and his own faultiness to fall upon a mortal. I’ll cut short my talk: the door makes a noise. See, the counterfeit Amphitryon is coming out of doors, and together with him Alcmena, the wife that he has taken the loan of.

1.3.499

499 Béne vale, Alcumena, cura rem communem, quod facis;
500 atque inperce quaeso: menses iam tibi esse actos vides.
501 mihi necesse est ire hinc; verum quod erit natum tollito.
502 Quid istuc est, mi vir, negoti, quod tu tam subito domo
503 abeas?
503b Edepol haud quod tui me neque domi distaedeat;
504 sed ubi summus imperator non adest ad exercitum,
505 citius quod non facto est usus fit quam quod facto est opus.
506 Nimis hic scitust sycophanta, qui quidem meus sit pater.
507 observatote eum, quam blande mulieri palpabitur.
508 Ecastor te experior quanti facias uxorem tuam.
509 Satin habes, si feminarum nulla est quam aeque diligam?
510 Edepol ne illa si istis rebus te sciat operam dare,
511 ego faxim ted Amphitruonem esse malis, quam Iovem.
512 Experiri istuc mavellem me quam mi memorarier.
513 prius abis quam lectus ubi cubuisti concaluit locus.
514 heri venisti media nocte, nunc abis. hocin placet?
515 Accedam atque hanc appellabo et subparasitabor patri.

516 numquam edepol quemquam mortalem credo ego uxorem suam
517 sic ecflictim amare, proinde ut hic te ecflictim deperit.
518 Carnufex, non ego te novi? ábin e conspectu meo?
519 quid tibi hanc curatio est rem, verbero, aut muttitio?
520 quoii ego iam hoc scipione—
520b Ah noli.
520c Muttito modo.
521 Nequiter paene expedivit prima parasitatio.
522 Verum quod tu dicis, mea uxor, non te mi irasci decet.
523 clanculum abii a legione: operam hanc subrupui tibi,
524 ex me primo ut prima scires, rem ut gessissem publicam.
525 ea tibi omnia enarravi. nisi te amarem plurimum,
499 Kindly fare you well, Alcmena; take care, as you are doing, of our common interest, 500 and pray be sparing of yourself; you see that now your months are completed. It’s necessary for me to go away from here; but the offspring that shall be born do you bring up . 502 What business is this, my husband, since you thus suddenly leave your home? 503b By my troth, ’tis not that I am wearied of you or of my home; but when the chief commander is not with the army, 505 that is sooner done which ought not to be done than that which needs to be done. 506 This is a very clever counterfeit, who really is my own father. (To the AUDIENCE.) Do you observe him, how blandly he smoothes the lady over. 508 I’ faith, I find by experience how much you value your wife. 509 If there is no one among women whom I love so much, are you satisfied? 510 Verily, upon my faith, if Juno only knew that you were giving your attention to such matters, I’d warrant that you’d rather be Amphitryon than Jupiter. 512 I would rather that I should find it so by experience, than that it should be told me. You leave me before the spot in the bed where.you have been lying has well grown warm. Yesterday, in the middle of the night, you came, and now you are going away. Is this your pleasure? 515 I’ll approach, and address her, and play second fiddle to my father. (He approaches ALCMENA.) Never, upon my faith, do I believe that any mortal did so. distractedly love his wife as he distractedly dotes upon you. 518 Scoundrel!—don’t I know you of old? Won’t you be off out of my sight? What business have you in this matter, whip-knave? or why your muttering? 520 Whom this very instant, with this walking-stick, I’ll— 520b Oh don’t. 520c Only make a whisper. 521 My first attempt at playing second fiddle had almost come to an unfortunate conclusion. 522 But as to what you say, my wife, you ought not to be angry with me. I came away privately from the army: these moments I stole for you, that you the first might know from me the first, how I had managed the common interests. 525 All this have I related to you. If I had not loved you very much, I should not have done so. 526b Isn’t he doing just as I said? In her alarm, he is smoothing her down. 527 That the army then mayn’t find it out, I must return there privately, lest they should say that I have preferred my wife before the common interests. 529 By your departure you set your wife in tears. 529b Be quiet; don’t spoil your eyes: I’ll return very shortly. 530b That very shortly is a long time. 531 I do not with pleasure leave you here, or go away from you. 531b I am sensible of it; for, the night that you have come to me, on the same you go away. 532b Why do you hold me? It is time to go: I wish to depart from the city before it dawns. Now, Alcmena, this goblet which has been given me there on account of my valour, 535 from which king Pterelas used to drink, he whom I slew with my own hand, the same I present to you. 536b You do as you are wont in other things. By heavens, it is a noble gift; like him who gave the gift. 538 Aye, a noble gift; just like her to whom it has been given as a gift. 539 What, still going on? Can’t I, you scoundrel, make an end of you? 540 Amphitryon, there’s a dear, don’t be angry with Sosia on my account. 541 Just as you wish I’ll do. 541b From his intriguing, how very savage he does become! 542 Do you wish for anything else? 542b That when I am absent you will love me—me, who am

yours, though absent. 543 Let’s go, Amphitryon; it’s already dawning. 543b Go you first, Sosia. (Exit MERCURY.) I’ll follow this instant. (To ALCMENA.) Is there anything you wish? 544b Yes; that you’ll come back speedily. 544c I will; 545 and sooner than you expect will I be here therefore be of good heart. (ALCMENA goes into the house.) Now Night, thou who hast tarried for me, I permit these to give place to Day, that thou mayst shine upon mortals with a bright and brilliant light. And Night, as much as on this last thou wast too long, so much the shorter will I make the Day to be, 550 that a Day of equal disparity may succeed the Night. I’ll go and follow Mercury.

1.3.526

526 non facerem.
526b Facitne ut dixi? timidam palpo percutit.
527 Nunc, ne legio persentiscat, clam illuc redeundum est mihi,
528 ne me uxorem praevertisse dicant prae re publica.
529 Lacrimantem ex abitu concinnas tu tuam uxorem.
529b Tace,
530 ne corrumpe oculos, redibo actutum.
530b Id actutum diu est.
531 Non ego te hic lubens relinquo neque abeo abs te.
531b Sentio,
532 nam qua nocte ad me venisti, eadem abis.
532b Cur me tenes?
533 tempus est: exire ex urbe prius quam lucescat volo.
534 nunc tibi hanc pateram, quae dono mi illi ob virtutem data est,
535 Pterela rex qui potitavit, quem ego mea occidi manu,
536 Alcumena, tibi condono.
536b Facis ut alias res soles.
537 ecastor condignum donum, qualest qui donum dedit.
538 Immo sic: condignum donum, qualest cui dono datumst.
539 Pergin autem? nonne ego possum, furcifer, te perdere?
540 Noli amabo, Amphitruo, irasci Sosiae causa mea.
541 Faciam ita ut vis.
541b Ex amore hic admodum quam saevos est.
542 Numquid vis?
542b Vt quom absim mé ames, me tuam te absente tamen.
543 Eamus, Amphitruo. lucescit hoc iam.
543b Abi prae, Sosia,
544 iam ego sequar. numquid vis?
544b Etiam: ut actutum advenias.
544c Licet,

1.3.545

545 prius tuá opinione híc adero: bonum ánimum habe.—
546 nunc te, nox, quae me mansisti, mitto uti cedas die,
547 ut mortalis inlucescat luce clara et candida.
548 atque quanto, nox, fuisti longior hac proxuma,
549 tanto brevior dies ut fiat faciam, ut aeque disparet.
550 sed dies e nocte accedat. ibo et Mercurium sequar.—

2.1.551

551 Age í tu secúndum.
551b Sequór, subsequór te.
552 Scelestissimum te arbitror.
552b Nam quam ob rem?
553 Quia id quod neque est neque fuit neque futurum est
554 mihi praedicas.
554b Eccere, iam tuatim
555 facis tu, ut tuis nulla apud te fides sit.
556 Quid est? quo modo? iam quidem hercle ego tibi istam
557 scelestam, scelus, linguam abscidam.
557b Tuos sum,
558 proinde ut commodumst et lubet quidque facias;
559 tamen quin loquar haec uti facta sunt hic,
560 numquam ullo modo me potes deterrere.
561 Scelestissime, audes mihi praedicare id,
562 domi te esse nunc, qui hic ades?
562b Vera dico.
563 Malum quod tibi di dabunt, atque ego hodie
564 dabo.
564b Istuc tibist in manu, nam tuos sum.
565 Tun me, verbero, audes erum ludificari?
566 tune id dicere audes, quod nemo umquam homo antehac
567 vidit nec potest fieri, tempore uno
568 homo idem duobus locis ut simul sit?
569 Profecto ut loquor res ita est.
569b Iuppiter te
570 perdat.
570b Quid mali súm, ere, tua ex re promeritus?
571 Rogasne, improbe, etiam, qui ludos facis me?
572 Meritó maledicás mihi, si id ita factum est.†

551 Come, do you follow after me. 551b I'm following; I'm following close after you. 552 I think that you are the veriest rogue— 552b But for what reason? 553 Because that which neither is, nor ever was, nor will be, you declare to me. 554b Look at that; you are now acting according to 555 your usual fashion, to be putting no trust in your servants. 556 Why is it so? For what reason? Surely now, by the powers, I'll cut out that villanous tongue of yours, you villain. 557b I am yours; do each thing just as it is agreable and as it pleases you. 559 Still you never can, by any method, hinder me from saying these things just as they took place here. 561 You consummate villain, do you dare tell me this, that you are now at home, who are here present? 562b I speak the truth. 563 A mishap shall the Gods send upon you, and I this day will send it as well. 564b That's in your power, for I am your property. 565 Do you dare, you whip-scoundrel, to play your tricks with me, your master? Do you dare affirm that which no person ever yet before this has seen, and which cannot possibly happen, for the same man to be in two places together at the same time? 569 Undoubtedly, such as I say is the fact. 569b May Jupiter confound you! 570b What evil, master, have I been deemed deserving of in your service? 571 Do you ask me, you rogue, who are even making sport of me? 572 With reason might you curse me, if it had not so happened. But I tell no lie, and I speak as the thing really did happen. 574 This fellow's drunk, as I imagine. 575 What, I? 575b Yes—you there. 575c I wish I were so. 575d You are wishing for that which is fact; where have you been drinking? 576 Nowhere, indeed. 576b What is this, that is the matter with the fellow? 576c Really I have told you ten times over. I

am both at home now, I say (do you mark me?), and I, Sosia, am with you likewise. Don’t I appear, master, to have told you quite distinctly, and quite circumstantially, that this is so. 579b Avaunt, 580 get away with you from me.

2.1.573

573 verum haud mentior, resque uti facta dico.
574 Homo hic ébrius est, ut opínor.
575 Útinam ita essem.
575b Optás quae facta.
575c Égone?
575d Tu istic. úbi bibisti?
576 Nusquam equidem bibi.
576b Quid hoc sithominis?
576c equidem decies dixi:
577 domi ego sum, inquam, écquid audis? et apud te adsum Sosia idem.
578 satin hoc plane, satin diserte, ere, nunc videor
579 tibi locutus esse?
579b Vah,
580 ápage te a me.
580b Quíd est negoti?
581 Péstis te tenet.
581b Nám quor istuc
582 dicis? equidem valeo et salvos
583 sum recte, Amphitruo.
583b At te ego faciam
584 hodie proinde ac meritus es,
584a ut minus valeas et miser sis,
584b salvos domum si rediero: iam
585a sequere sis, erum qui ludificas
585b dictis delirantibus,
586 qui quoniam erus quod imperavit neglexisti persequi,
587 nunc venis etiam ultro inrisum dominum: quae neque fieri
588 possunt neque fando umquam accepit quisquam profers, carnifex;
589 quoius ego hodie in tergum faxo ista expetant mendacia.
590 Amphitruo, miserrima istaec miseria est servo bono,

580b What’s the matter? 581 A pestilence possesses you. 581b But why do you say so to me? I really am quite well and in perfect health, Amphitryon. 583b But I’ll make you this very day, just as you have deserved, not to be quite so well, and to be miserable instead of your perfect health, if I return home. 585a Follow me, you who in this fashion are making sport of your master with your crack-brained talk; you, who, since you have neglected to perform what your master ordered, are now come even of your own accord to laugh at your master. Things which neither can happen, and which no one ever yet heard of in talk, you are telling of, you villain; on your back I’ll take care and make those lies to tell this very day. 590 Amphitryon, this is the most wretched of wretchedness to a good servant, who is telling the truth to his master, if that same truth is overpowered by violence. 592 Discuss it with me by proofs. Why, how the plague can such a thing happen, for you now to be both here and at home? That I want to be told. 594 I really am both here and there; this any person has a right to wonder at; nor, Amphitryon, does this seem more. strange to you than to myself. 596 In what way? 596b In no degree, I say, is this more strange to you than to myself; nor, so may the Deities love me, did I at first credit Sosia—me myself, until that Sosia, I myself, made me to believe me myself. In order did he relate everything, as each

thing came to pass, when we sojourned with the enemy; 600 and then besides, he has carried off my figure together with my name. Not even is milk more like to milk than is that I myself like to me myself. For when some time since, before daybreak, you sent me from the harbour home before you— 603 What then? 603b I had been standing a long time at the door before I had got there. 604 Plague on it, what nonsense! Are you quite in your senses? 604b I’m just as you see me. 605 Some mischief, I know not what, has befallen this fellow from an evil hand since he left me. 606b I confess it; for I have been most shockingly bruised with his fists. 607 Who has been beating you? 607b I myself, who am now at home, beat me myself. 608 Take you care to say nothing but what I shall ask you. Now, do you answer me. First of all, who this Sosia is, of that I want to be informed. 610 He is your servant. 610b Really I have even more than I desire by your own one self. Never, too, since I was born, had I a servant Sosia besides yourself. 612 But now, Amphitryon, I say this; I’ll make you, I say, on your arrival, meet with another Sosia at home, a servant of yours, besides myself, a son of Davus, the same father with myself, of figure and age as well 615 just like myself. What need is there of words? This Sosia of yours is become twofold. 616 You talk of things extremely wonderful. But did you see my wife? 617 Nay, but it was never allowed me to go in-doors into the house. 617b Who hindered you? 618 This Sosia, whom I was just now telling of, he who thumped me. 619 Who is this Sosia? 619b Myself, I say; how often must it be told you?

2.1.591

591 apud erum qui vera loquitur, si id vi verum vincitur.
592 Quo id, malum, pacto potest nam (mecum argumentis puta)
593 fieri, nunc uti tu et hic sis et domi? id dici volo.
594 Sum profecto et hic et illíc. hoc cuivis mirari licet,
595 neque tibi istuc mirum mágis videtur quam mihi.
596 Quo modo?
596b Nihilo, inquam, mirum magis tibi istuc quam mihi;
597 neque, ita me di ament, credebam primo mihimet Sosiae,
598 donec Sosia illic egomet fecit sibi uti crederem.
599 ordine omne, uti quicque actum est, dúm apud hostis sedimus,
600 edissertavit. tum formam una abstulit cum nomine.
601 neque lac lactis magis est simile quam ille ego similest mei.
602 nam ut dudum ante lucem a portu me praemisisti domum—
603 Quid igitur?
603b Prius multo ante aedis stabam quam illo adveneram.
604 Quas, malum, nugás? satin tu sanus es?
604b Sic sum ut vides.
605 Huic homini nescio quid est mali mala obiectum manu,
606 postquam a me abiit.
606b Fateor, nam sum obtusus pugnis pessume.
607 Quis te verberavit?
607b Egomet memet, qui nunc sum domi.
608 Cave quicquam, nisi quod rogabo te, mihi responderis.
609 omnium primum iste qui sit Sosia, hoc dici volo.
610 Tuos est servos.
610b Mihi quidem uno te plus etiam est quam volo,
611 neque postquam sum natus habui nisi te servom Sosiam.
612 At ego nunc, Amphitruo, dico: Sosiam servom tuom
613 praeter me alterum, inquam, adveniens faciam ut offendas domi,
614 Davo prognatum patre eodem quo égo sum, forma, aetate item

2.1.615

615 qua égo sum. quid opust verbis? geminus Sosia hic factust tibi.
616 Nimia memoras mira. sed vidistin uxorem meam?
617 Quin intro ire in aedis numquam licitum est.
617b Quis te prohibuit?
618 Sosia ille, quem iam dudum dico, is qui me contudit.
619 Quis istic Sosia est?
619b Ego, inquam. quotiens dicendum est tibi?
620 Sed quid ais? num obdormivisti dudum?
620b Nusquam gentium.
621 Ibi forte istum si vidisses quendam in somnis Sosiam—
622 Non soleo ego somniculose éri imperia persequi.
623 vigilans vidi, vigilans nunc te video, vigilans fabulor,
624 vigilantem ille me iam dudum vigilans pugnis contudit.
625 Quis homo?
625b Sosia, inquam, ego ille. quaeso, nonne intellegis?
626 Qui, malum, intellegere quisquam potis est? ita nugas blatis.
627 Verum actutum nosces, quom illum nosces servom Sosiam.
628 Sequere hac igitur me, nam mi istuc primum exquisito est opus.
629
630
631
632

620 But how say you? Have you been sleeping the while? 620b Not the slightest in the world. 621 Then, perhaps, you might perchance have seen some Sosia in your dreams. 622 I am not in the habit of performing the orders of my master in a sleepy fashion. Awake I saw him, awake I now see you, awake I am talking, awake did he, a little while since, thump me about with his fists. 625 What person did so? 625b Sosia, that I myself,—he, I say. Prithee, don't you understand? 626 How, the plague, can any one possibly understand? You are jabbering such nonsense. 627 But you'll know him shortly. 627b Whom? 627c You'll know this servant Sosia. 628 Follow me this way, then; for it is necessary for me first to enquire into this. But take care that all the things that I ordered are now brought from the ship. 630 I am both mindful and diligent that what you order shall be performed; together with the wine, I have not drunk up your commands. 632 May the Gods grant, that, in the event, what you have said may prove untrue.

2.2.633

633 Satín parva rés est volúptatum in víta atque in aétate agúnda
634 praequám quod moléstum est? ita cuíque comparátum est in aétate hominum;
635 ita dívis est plácitum, volúptatem ut maéror comés consequátur:
636 quin íncommodí plus malíque ilico ádsit, boní si optigít quid.
637 nam ego íd nunc expérior domo átque ipsa dé me sció, cui volúptas
638 parúmper datást, dum virí mei míhi potéstas vidéndi fuit
639 noctem únam modo; átque is repénte abiit á me hinc ánte lucem.
640 sola híc mihi nunc vídeor, quia ílle hinc abést quem ego amó praeter omnes.
641 plus aégri ex ábitu virí, quam ex advéntu volúptatis cépi. sed hóc me beát
642 saltém, quom perduéllis vicít et domúm laudis cómpos revénit:
643 id sólacio est.
644 absít, dum modó laude párta
645 domúm recipiát se; feram ét perferam úsque
646 abitum éius ánimo forti átque offirmáto, id módo si mercédis

647 datúr mi, ut meús victor vír belli clúeat.
648 satis mi esse ducam.
648b virtús praemium ést optimúm;
649 virtús omnibús rebus ánteit profécto:
650 libértas salús vita rés et paréntes, patria ét prognáti
651 tutántur, servántur:
652 virtús omnia ín sese habét, omnia ádsunt
653 bona quém penest vírtus.
654 Édepol me uxori éxoptatum crédo adventurúm domum,
655 quae me amat, quam contra amo, praesertim re gesta bene,
656 victis hostibus: quos nemo posse superari ratust,
657 eos auspicio meo atque ductu primo coetu vicimus.
658 certe enim méd illi expectatum optato venturum scio.
659 Quid? me non rere expectatum amicae venturum meae?
660 Meus vir hic quidem est.
660b Séquere hac tu me.
633 Is not the proportion of pleasures in life and in passing our existence short in comparison with what is disagreable? So it is allotted to each man in life; 635 so has it pleased the Gods that Sorrow should attend on Pleasure as her companion; but if aught of good befalls us, more of trouble and of ill forthwith attends us. For this do I now feel by experience at home and in relation to myself, to whom delight has been imparted for a very short time, while I had the opportunity of seeing my husband for but one night; and now has he suddenly gone away hence from me before the dawn. 640 Deserted do I now seem to myself, because he is absent from here, he whom before all I love. More of grief have I felt from the departure of my husband, than of pleasure from his arrival. But this, at least, makes me happy, that he has conquered the foe, and has returned home loaded with glory. Let him be absent, if only with fame acquired 645 he betakes himself home. I shall bear and ever endure his absence with mind resolved and steadfast; if only this reward is granted me, that my husband shall be hailed the conqueror in the warfare, sufficient for myself will I deem it. Valour is the best reward; valour assuredly surpasses all things: 650 liberty, safety, life, property and parents, country too, and children, by it are defended and preserved. Valour comprises everything in itself: all blessings attend him in whose possession is valour. 654 By my troth, I do believe that I shall come much wished for by my wife, 655 who loves me, and whom, in return, I love: especially, our enterprise crowned with success, the enemy vanquished, whom no one had supposed to be able to be conquered: these, under my conduct and command, at the first meeting, have we vanquished; but I know for sure that I shall come to her much wished for. 659 Well, and don’t you think that I shall come much wished for to my mistress? 660 Surely, this is my husband. 660b Do you follow me this way. 660c But why has he returned, when just now he said that he was in haste? Is he purposely trying me, and is he desirous to make proof of this, how much I regret his departure? By my faith, against no inclination of mine has he betaken himself home. 664 Amphitryon, it were better for us to return to the ship. 664b For what reason? 665 Because there’s no person at home to give us a breakfast on our arrival. 666 How comes that now into your mind? 666b Why, because we have come too late. 667 How so? 667b Because I see Alcmena standing before the house, with her stomach-full already. 668 I left her pregnant here when I went away. 668b Alas, to my sorrow, I’m undone! 669 What’s the matter with you? 669b I have come home just in good time to fetch the water 670 in the tenth month after that, according as I understand you to compute the reckoning. 671 Be of good heart. 671b Do you know of how good heart I am? By my troth, do you never after this day entrust to me aught that is sacred, if I don’t draw up all the life of that well, if I do but make a beginning. 674 Do you only follow me this way. I’ll appoint

another person for that business; don’t you fear. 675 I think that I shall now be doing my duty more, if I go to meet him. 676 With joy, Amphitryon greets his longed for wife—her, whom of all women in Thebes her husband deems by far the most excellent, and whom so much the Theban citizens truthfully extol as virtuous. Have you fared well all along? Do I arrive much wished for by you? 679b I never saw one more so; 680 for she greets her own husband not a bit more than a dog.

2.2.660c

660c Nam quid ille revortitur
661 qui dudum properare se aibat? án ille me temptat sciens
662 atque id se volt experiri, suom abitum ut desiderem?
663 ecastor med haud invita se domum recipit suam.
664 Amphitruo, redire ad navem meliust nos.
664b Qua gratia?
665 Quia domi daturus nemo est prandium advenientibus.
666 Qui tibi nunc istuc in mentemst?
666b Quia enim sero advenimus.
667 Qui?
667b Quia Alcumenam ante aedis stare saturam intellego.
668 Gravidam ego illanc hic reliqui quóm abeo.
668b Ei perii miser.
669 Quid tibi est?
669b Ad aquam praebendam commodum adveni domum,
670 decumo post mense, ut rationem te putare intellego.
671 Bono animo es.
671b Scin quam bono animo sim? si situlam cepero,
672 numquam edepol tu mihi divini creduis post hunc diem,
673 ní ego illi puteo, si occepso, ánimam omnem intertraxero.
674 Sequere hac me modo; alium ego isti rei allegabo, ne time.
675 Magis nunc me meum officium facere, si huic eam advorsum, arbitror.
676 Amphitruo uxorem salutat laetus speratam suam,
677 quam omnium Thebis vir unam esse optimam diiudicat,
678 quamque adeo cives Thebani vero rumiferant probam.
679 valuistin usque? exspectatun advenio?
679b Haud vidi magis.
680 exspectatum eum salutat magis haud quicquam quam canem.
681 Et quom te †gravidam et quom te pulchre plenam aspicio, gaudeo.
682 Obsecro ecastor, quid tu me deridiculi gratia
681 When I see you pregnant, and so gracefully burdened, I am delighted. 682 Prithee, in the name of all that’s good, why, for the sake of mockery, do you thus salute and address me, as though you hadn’t lately seen me—as though now, for the first time, you were betaking yourself homeward here from the enemy? 685 For now you are addressing me just as though you were seeing me after a long time. 686 Why, really for my part, I have not seen you at all this day until now. 687 Why do you deny it? 687b Because I have learned to speak the truth. 687c He does not do right, who unlearns the same that he has learned. Are you making trial what feelings I possess? But why are you returning hither so soon? 690 Has an ill omen delayed you, or does the weather keep you back, you who have not gone away to your troops, as you were lately speaking of? 692 Lately? How long since was this lately? 692b You are trying me; but very lately, just now. 693 Prithee, how can that possibly be as you say?—but very lately, just now. 694 Why, what do you imagine? That I, on the other hand, shall trifle with you who are playing with me, 695 in saying that you are now

come for the first time, you who but just now went away from here? 696 Surely she is talking deliriously. 696b Stop a little while, until she has slept out this one sleep. 697b Is she not dreaming with her eyes open? 698 Upon my faith, for my part I really am awake, and awake I am relating that which has happened; for, but lately, before daybreak, I saw both him (pointing at SOSIA) and yourself. 699b In what place? 700 Here, in the house where you yourself dwell. 700b It never was the fact. 700c Will you not hold your peace? What if the vessel brought us here from the harbour in our sleep? 702 Are you, too, going to back her as well? 702b What do you wish to be done? Don’t you know, if you wish to oppose a raving Bacchanal, from a mad woman you’ll render her more mad—she’ll strike the oftener; 705 if you humour her, after one blow you may overcome her? 705b But, by my troth, this thing is resolved upon, somehow to rate her who this day has been unwilling to greet me on my arrival home. 707b You’ll only be irritating hornets. 707c You hold your tongue. Alcmena, I wish to ask you one thing. 708b Ask me anything you please. 709 Is it frenzy that has come upon you, or does pride overcome you? 710 How comes it into your mind, my husband, to ask me that?

2.2.683

683 sic salutas atque appellas, quasi dudum non videris
684 quasique nunc primum recipias te domum huc ex hostibus?
685
686 Immo equidem te nisi nunc hodie nusquam vidi gentium.
687 Cur negas?
687b Quia vera didici dicere.
687c Haud aequom facit
688 qui quod didicit id dediscit. an periclitamini
689 quid animi habeam? sed quid huc vos revortimini tam cito?
690 an te auspicium commoratum est an tempestas continet
691 qui non abiisti ad legiones, ita uti dudum dixeras?
692 Dudum? quam dudum istuc factum est?
692b Temptas. iam dudum, modo.
693 Qui istuc potis est fieri, quaeso, ut dicis: iam dudum, modo?
694 Quid enim censes? te ut deludam contra lusorem meum,
695 qui nunc primum te advenisse dicas, modo qui hinc abieris.
696 Haec quidem deliramenta loquitur.
696b Paulisper mane,
697 dum edormiscat unum somnum.
697b Quaene vigilans somniat?
698 Equidem ecastor vigilo, et vigilans id quod factum est fabulor.
699 nam dudum ante lucem et istunc et te vidi.
699b Quo in loco?
700 Hic in aedibús ubi tu habitas.
700b Numquam factum est.
700c Non taces?
701 quid si e portu navis huc nos dormientis detulit?
702 Etiam tu quoque adsentaris húic?
702b Quid vis fieri?
703 non tu scis? Bacchae bacchanti si velis advorsarier,

2.2.704

704 ex insana insaniorem facies, feriet saepius;

705 si obsequare, una resolvas plaga.
705b At pol qui certa res
706 hanc est obiurgare, quae me hódie advenientem domum
707 noluerit salutare.
707b Inritabis crabrones.
707c Tace.
708 Alcumena, unum rogare te volo.
708b Quid vis roga.
709 Num tibi aut stultitia accessit aut superat superbia?
710 Qui istuc in mentemst tibi ex me, mi vir, percontarier?
711 Quia salutare advenientem me solebas antidhac,
712 appellare, itidem ut pudicae suos viros quae sunt solent.
713 eo more expertem te factam adveniens offendi domi.
714 Ecastor equidem te certo heri advenientem ílico,
715 et salutavi et valuissesne usque exquisivi simul,
716 mi vir, et manum prehendi et osculum tetuli tibi.
717 Tun heri hunc salutavisti?
717b Et te quoque etiam, Sosia.
718 Amphitruo, speravi ego istam tibi parituram filium;
719 verum non est puero gravida.
719b Quid igitur?
719c Insania.
720 Equidem sana sum et deos quaeso, ut salva pariam filium.
721 verum tu malum mágnum habebis, si hic suom officium facit:
722 ob istuc omen, ominator, capies quod te condecet.
723 Enim vero praegnati oportet et malum et malum dari,
724 ut quod obrodat sit, animo si male esse occeperit.
725 Tu me heri hic vidisti?
725b Ego, inquam, si vis decies dicere.
711 Because formerly you used to greet me on my arrival, and to address me in such manner as those women who are virtuous are wont their husbands. On my arrival home I've found that you have got rid of that custom. 714 By my faith, indeed, I assuredly did both greet you yesterday, upon your arrival, 715 at that very instant, and at the same time I enquired if you had continued in health all along, my husband, and I took your hand and gave you a kiss. 717 What, did you welcome him yesterday? 717b And you too, as well, Sosia. 718 Amphitryon, I did hope that she was about to bring you forth a son; but she isn't gone with child. 719b What then? 719c With madness. 720 Really I am in my senses, and I pray the Gods that in safety I may bring forth a son; but (to SOSIA) hap-ill shall you be having, if he does his duty: for those ominous words, omen-maker, you shall catch what befits you. 723 Why really an apple ought to be given to the lady thus pregnant, that there may be something for her to gnaw if she should begin to faint. 725 Did you see me here yesterday? 725b I did, I say, if you wish it to be ten times repeated. 726 In your sleep, perhaps? 726b No—I, awake, saw you awake. 726c Woe to me! 727 What's the matter with you? 727b My wife is mad. 727c She's attacked with black bile; nothing so soon turns people mad. 729 When, madam, did you first find yourself affected? 730 Why really, upon my faith, I'm well, and in my senses. 730b Why, then, do you say that you saw me yesterday, whereas we were brought into harbour but last night? There did I dine, and there did I rest the livelong night on board ship, nor have I set my foot even here into the house, since, with the army, I set out hence against the Teleboan foe, and since we conquered them. 735 On the contrary, you dined with me, and you slept with me. 735b How so? 736 I'm telling the truth. 736b On my honor, not in this matter, really; about other

matters I don’t know. 737 At the very break of dawn you went away to your troops. 737b By what means could I? 738 She says right, according as she remembers; she’s telling you her dream. But, madam, after you arose, you ought to have sacrificed to Jove, the disposer of prodigies, 740 either with a salt cake or with frankincense. 741 A mischief on your head!

2.2.726

726 In somnis fortasse.
726b Immo vígilans vigilantem.
726c Ei misero mihi.
727 Quid tibi est?
727b Delirat uxor.
727c Atra bili percita est.
728 nulla res tam delirantis homines concinnat cito.
729 Vbi primum tibi sensisti, mulier, impliciscier?
730 Equidem ecastor sana et salva sum.
730b Quor igitur praedicas,
731 té heri me vidisse, qui hac noctu in portum advecti sumus?
732 ibi cenavi atque ibi quievi in navi noctem perpetem,
733 neque meum pedem huc íntuli etiam in aedis, ut cum exercitu
734 hinc profectus sum ad Teloboas hostis eosque ut vicimus.
735 Immo mecum cenavisti et mecum cubuisti.
735b Quid est?
736 Vera dico.
736b Non de hac quidem hercle re; de áliis nescio.
737 Primulo diluculo abiisti ad legiones.
737b Quo modo?
738 Recte dicit, ut commeminit: somnium narrat tibi.
739 sed, mulier, postquam experrecta es, te prodigiali Iovi
740 aut mola salsa hodie aut ture comprecatam oportuit.
741 Vae capiti tuó.
741b Tua istuc refert—si curaveris.
742 Iterum iám hic in me inclementer dicit, atque id sine malo.
743 Tace tu. tu dic: egone abs te abii hinc hodie cum diluculo?
744 Quis igitur nisi vos narravit mi, illi ut fuerit proelium?
745 An etiam id tu scis?
745b Quippe qui éx te audivi, ut urbem maximam

741b That’s your own business, if you take due care. 742 Now again this fellow is talking rudely to me, and that without punishment. 743 You hold your tongue. (To ALCMENA.) Do you tell me now—did I go away hence from you at daybreak? 744 Who then but your own self recounted to me how the battle went there? 745 And do you know that as well? 745b Why, I heard it from your own self, how you had taken a very large city, and how you yourself had slain king Pterelas. 747 What, did I tell you this? 747b You yourself, this Sosia standing by as well. 748 Have you heard me telling about this to-day? 748b Where should I have heard you? 749 Ask her. 749b In my presence, indeed, it never took place, that I know of. 750 It would be a wonder if he didn’t contradict you. 750b Sosia, come here and look at me. 751 I am looking at you. 751b I wish you to tell the truth, and I don’t want you to humour me. Have you heard me this day sav to her these things which she affirms? 753 Prithee now, by my troth, are you, too, mad as well, when you ask me this, me, who, for my part, my own self now behold her in company with you for the first time? 755 How now, madam? Do you hear him? 755b I do, indeed, and telling an untruth. 756 Do you believe neither him nor my own self, your husband? 756b No; for this reason it is, because I most

readily believe myself, and I am sure that these things took place just as I relate them. 758 Do you say that I came yesterday? 758b Do you deny that you went away from here to-day? 759 I really do deny it, and I declare that I have now come home to you for the first time. 760 Prithee, will you deny this too, that you to-day made me a present of a golden goblet, with which you said that you had been presented? 762 By heavens, I neither gave it nor told you so: but I had so intended, and do so now, to present you with that goblet. But who told you this? 764b Why, I heard it from yourself, and I received the goblet from your own hand. 765b Stay, stay, I entreat you. Sosia, I marvel much how she knows that I was presented there with this golden goblet, unless you have lately met her and told her all this. 768 Upon my faith, I have never told her, nor have I ever beheld her except with yourself. 769 What is the matter with this person?

2.2.746

746 expugnavisses regemque Pterelam tute occideris.
747 Egone istuc dixi?
747b Tute istic, etiam adstante hoc Sosia.
748 Audivistin tu me narrare haec hodie?
748b Vbi ego audiverim?
749 Hanc roga.
749b Me quidem praesente numquam factum est, quod sciam.
750 Mirum quin te adversus dicat.
750b Sosia, age me huc aspice.
751 Specto.
751b Vera volo loqui te, nolo adsentari mihi.
752 audivistin tu hodie me illi dicere ea quae illa autumat?
753 Quaeso edepol, num tu quoque etiam insanis, quom id me interrogas,
754 qui ipsus equidem nunc primum istanc tecum conspicio simul?
755 Quid nunc, mulier? audin illum?
755b Ego véro, ac falsum dicere.
756 Neque tu illi neque mihi viro ipsi credis?
756b Eo fit quia mihi
757 plurimum credo et scio istaec facta proinde ut proloquor.
758 Tun me heri advenisse dicis?
758b Tun te abiisse hodie hinc negas?
759 Nego enim vero, et me advenire nunc primum aio ad te domum.
760 Obsecro, etiamne hoc negabis, te auream pateram mihi
761 dédisse dono hodié, qua te illi donatum esse dixeras?
762 Neque edepol dedi neque dixi; verum ita animatus fui
763 itaque nunc sum, ut ea te patera donem. sed quis istúc tibi
764 dixit?
764b Ego equidem ex te audivi et ex tua accepi manu
765 pateram.
765b Mane, mane, obsecro te. nimis demiror, Sosia,

2.2.766

766 qui illaec illic me donatum esse aurea patera sciat,
767 nisi tu dudum hanc convenisti et narravisti haec omnia.
768 Neque edepol ego dixi neque istam vidi nisi tecum simul.
769 Quid hoc sit hominis?
769b Vin proferri pateram?

769c Proferri volo.
770 Fiat. heus tu, Thessala, intus pateram proferto foras,
771 qua hódie meus vir donavit me.
771b Secede huc tu, Sosia,
772 enim vero illud praeter alia mira miror maxime,
773 si haec habet páteram illam.
773b An etiam credis id, quae in hac cistellula
774 tuo signo obsignata fertur?
774b Salvom signum est?
774c Inspice.
775 Recte, ita est ut obsignavi.
775b Quaeso, quin tu istanc iubes
776 pro cerrita circumferri?
776b Edepol qui facto est opus;
777 nam haec quidem edepol laruarum plenast.
777b Quid verbis opust?
778 em tibi pateram, eccam.
778b Cedo mi.
778c Age aspice huc sis nunciam
779 tu qui quae facta infitiare; quem égo iam hic convincam palam.
780 estne haec patera, qua donatu's donatus es illi?
780b Summe Iuppiter,
781 quid ego video? haec ea est profecto patera. perii, Sosia.
782 Aut pol haec praestigiatrix multo mulier maxima est
783 aut pateram hic inesse oportet.
769b Should you like the goblet to be produced? 769c I should like it; to be produced. 770 Be it so. Do you go, Thessala, and bring from indoors the goblet, with which my husband presented me today. 771b Sosia, do you step this way. Really, I do wonder extremely at this beyond the other wondrous matters, if she has got this goblet. 773b And do you believe it, when it’s carried in this casket, sealed with your own seal. 774b Is the seal whole? 774c Examine it. 775 All right, it’s just as I sealed it up. 775b Prithee, why don’t you order her to be purified as a frantic person? 776b By my troth, somehow there’s need for it, for, i’ faith, she’s certainly filled with sprites. 777b What need is there of talking? See, here’s the goblet; here it is. 778b Give it me. 778c Come, now then, look here, if you please, you who deny what is fact, and whom I shall now clearly convict in this case. 780 Isn’t this the goblet with which you were presented there? 780b Supreme Jupiter! what do I behold? Surely this is that goblet. Sosia, I’m utterly confounded. 782 Upon my faith, either this woman is a most consummate juggler, or the goblet must be in here (pointing to the casket.) 783b Come, then, open this casket. 784 Why should I open it? It is securely sealed. The thing is cleverly contrived; 785 you have brought forth another Amphitryon, I have brought forth another Sosia; now if the goblet has brought forth a goblet, we have all produced our doubles. 787 I’m determined to open and examine it. 787b Look, please, how the seal is, that you may not hereafter throw the blame on me. 788b Now do open it. For she certainly is desirous to drive us mad with her talking. 790 Whence then came this which was made a present to me, but from yourself? 791 It’s necessary for me to enquire into this. 791b Jupiter, O Jupiter! 792 What is the matter with you? 792b There’s no goblet here in the casket. 792c What do I hear. 793 That which is the truth. 793b But at your peril now, if it does not make its appearance.

2.2.783b

783b Agedum, exsolve cistulam.

784 Quid ego istam exsolvam? obsignatast recte, res gesta est bene:
785 tu peperisti Ámphitruonem, ego alium peperi Sosiam;
786 nunc si patera pateram peperit, omnes congeminavimus.
787 Certum est aperire atque inspicere.
787b Vide sis signi quid siet,
788 ne posterius in me culpam conferas.
788b Aperi modo;
789 nam haec quidem nos delirantis facere dictis postulat.
790 Vnde haec igitur est nisi abs te quae mihi dono data est?
791 Opus mi est istuc exquisito.
791b Iuppiter, pro Iuppiter.
792 Quid tibi est?
792b Hic patera nulla in cistulast.
792c Quid ego audio?
793 Id quod verúmst.
793b At cum cruciatu iam, nisi apparet, tuo.
794 Haec quidem apparet.
794b Quis igitur tibi dedit?
794c Qui me rogat.
795 Me captas, quia tute ab navi clanculum huc alia via
796 praecucurristi, atque hinc pateram tute exemisti atque eam
797 huic dedisti, post hanc rursum óbsignasti clanculum.
798 Ei mihi, iam tu quoque huius adiuvas insaniam?
799 ain heri nos advenisse huc?
799b Aio, adveniensque ilico
800 me salutavisti, et ego te, et osculum tetuli tibi.
801 Iam illud non placet principium de osculo.
801b Perge exsequi.
802 Lavisti.
794 Why, it does make its appearance. 794b Who then gave it you? 794c The person that's asking me the question. 795 You are on the catch for me, inasmuch as you yourself have secretly run before me hither from the ship by another road, and have taken the goblet away from here and given it to her, and afterwards you have secretly sealed it up again. 798 Ah me! and are you too helping her frenzy as well? (To ALCMENA) Do you say that we arrived here yesterday? 799b I do say so, and on your arrival you instantly 800 greeted me, and I you, and I gave you a kiss. 801 That beginning now about the kiss doesn't please me. 801b Go on telling it. 802 Then you bathed. 802b What, after I bathed? 802c You took your place at table. 802d Bravo, capital! Now make further enquiry. 803b Don't you interrupt. (To ALCMENA.) Go on telling me. 804 The dinner was served; you dined with me; I reclined together with you at the repast. 805 What, on the same couch? 805b On the same. 805c Oh dear, I don't like this banquet. 806 Now do let her give her proofs. (To ALCMENA.) What, after we had dined? 807 You said that you were inclined to go to sleep; the table was removed; thence we went to bed. 808 Where did you lie? 808b In the chamber, in the same bed together with your. self. 809 You have proved my undoing. 809b What's the matter with you? 809c This very moment has she sent me to my grave. 810 How so, pray? 810b Don't address me. 810c What's the matter with you? 810d To my sorrow I'm undone, since, in my absence from here, dishonor has befallen her chastity. 812 In heaven's name, my lord, why, I beseech you, do I hear this from you?

2.2.802b

802b Quid postquam lavi?

802c Accubuisti.
802d Euge optime.
803 nunc exquire.
803b Ne interpella. perge porro dicere.
804 Cena adposita est; cenavisti mecum, ego accubui simul.
805 In eodem lectó?
805b In eodem.
805c Ei, non placet convivium.
806 Sine modo argumenta dicat. quid postquam cenavimus?
807 Te dormitare aibas; mensa ablata est, cubitum hinc abiimus.
808 Vbi tu cubuisti?
808b In eodem lectó tecum una in cubiculo.
809 Perdidisti.
809b Quid tibi est?
809c Haec me modo ad mortem dedit.
810 Quid iam, amabo?
810b Ne me appella.
810c Quid tibi est?
810d Perii miser,
811 quia pudicitiae huius vitium me hinc absente est additum.
812 Obsecro ecastor, cur istuc, mi vir, ex ted audio?
813 Vir ego tuos sim? ne me appella, falsa, falso nomine.
814 Haeret haec res, si quidem haec iam mulier facta est ex viro.
815 Quid ego feci, qua istaec propter dicta dicantur mihi?
816 Tute edictas facta tua, ex me quaeris quid deliqueris.
817 Quid ego tibi deliqui, si, cui nupta sum, tecum fui?
818 Tun mecum fueris? quid illac impudente audacius?
819 saltem, tute si pudoris egeas, sumas mutuom.
820 Istuc facinus, quod tu insimulas, nostro generi non decet.
813 I, your lord? False one, don’t call me by a false name. 814 ’Tis an odd matter this, if indeed he has been made into my lady from my lord. 815 What have I done, by reason of which these expressions are uttered to me? 816 You yourself proclaim your own doings; do you enquire of me in what you have offended? 817 In what have I offended you, if I have been with you to whom I am married? 818 You, been with me? What is there of greater effrontery than this impudent woman? At least, if you were wanting in modesty of your own, you might have borrowed it. 820 That criminality which you lay to my charge befits not my family. If you try to catch me in incontinence, you cannot convict me. 822 Immortal Gods! do you at least know me, Sosia? 823 Pretty well. 823b Did I not dine yesterday on board ship in the Persian Port? 824 I have witnesses as well, who can confirm that which I say. 825 I don’t know what to say to this matter, unless, perchance, there is another Amphitryon, who, perhaps, though you yourself are absent, takes care of your business, and who, in your absence, performs your duties here. For about that counterfeit Sosia it is very surprising. Certainly, about this Amphitryon, now, it is another matter still more surprising. 830 Some magician, I know not who, is bewildering this woman. 831 By the realms of the supreme Sovereign I swear, and by Juno, the matron Goddess, whom for me to fear and venerate it is most especially fitting, that no mortal being except yourself alone has ever touched my person in contact with his so as to render me unchaste. 834b I could wish that that was true. 835 I speak the truth, but in vain, since you will not believe me. 836 You are a woman; you swear at random. 836b She who has not done wrong, her it befits to be bold and to speak confidently and positively in her own behalf. 838 That’s very boldly said. 838b Just as befits a virtuous woman. 838c Say you so? By your own words you prove it. 839 That

which is called a dowry, I do not deem the same my dowry; 840 but chastity, and modesty, and subdued desires, fear of the Gods, and love of my parents, and concord with my kindred; to be obedient to yourself and bounteous to the good, ready to aid the upright. 843 Surely, by my troth, if she tells the truth in this, she’s perfect to the very ideal . 844 Really I am so bewildered, that I don’t know myself who I am. 845 Surely you are Amphitryon; take you care, please, that you don’t peradventure lose yourself; people are changing in such a fashion since we came from abroad. 847 Madam, I’m resolved not to omit having this matter enquired into. 848 I’ faith, you’ll do so quite to my satisfaction. 848b How say you? Answer me; what if I bring your own kinsman, Naucrates, hither from the ship, 850 who, together with me, has been brought on board the same ship; and if he denies that that has happened which you say has happened, what is proper to be done to you? Do you allege any reason. why I should not at your cost dissolve this our marriage?

2.2.821

821 tu si me inpudicitiai captas, capere non potes.
822 Pro di immortales, cognoscin tu me saltem, Sosia?
823 Propemodum.
823b Cenavin ego heri in navi in portu Persico?
824 Mihi quoque adsunt testes, qui illud quod ego dicam adsentiant.
825 Nescio quid istúc negoti dicam, nisi si quispiam est
826 Amphitruó alius, qui forte ted hinc absenti tamen
827 tuam rem curet teque absente hic munus fungatur tuom.
828 nam quod de illo subditivo Sosia mirum nimis,
829 certe de istoc Amphitruone iam alterum mirum est magis.
830 Nescio quis praestigiator hanc frustratur mulierem.
831 Per supremi regis regnum iuro et matrem familias
832 Iunonem, quam me vereri et metuere est par maxume,
833 ut mi extra unum te mortalis nemo corpus corpore
834 contigit, quo me impudicam faceret.
834b Vera istaec velim.
835 Vera dico, sed nequiquam, quoniam non vis credere.
836 Mulier es, audacter iuras.
836b Quae non deliquit, decet
837 audacem esse, confidenter pro se et proterve loqui.
838 Satis audacter.
838b Vt pudicam decet.
838c †In verbis probas.
839 Non ego illam mihi dotem duco esse, quae dos dicitur,
840 sed pudicitiam et pudorem et sedatum cupidinem,
841 deum metum, parentum amorem et cognatum concordiam,
842 tibi morigera atque ut munifica sim bonis, prosim probis.
843 Ne ista edepol, si haec vera loquitur, examussim est optima.
844 Delenitus sum profecto ita, ut me qui sim nesciam.
845 Amphitruo es profecto, cave sis ne tu te usu perduis:

2.2.846

846 ita nunc homines immutantur, postquam peregre advenimus.
847 Mulier, istam rem inquisitam certum est non amittere.
848 Edepol me libente facies.
848b Quid ais? responde mihi,

849 quid si adduco tuom cognatum húc a navi Naucratem,
850 qui mecum una vectust una navi, atque is si denegat
851 facta quae tu facta dicis, quid tibi aequom est fieri?
852 numquid causam dicis, quin te hoc multem matrimonio?
853 Si deliqui, nulla causa est.
853b Convenit. tu, Sosia,
854 duc hos intro. ego huc ab navi mecum adducam Naucratem.—
855 Nunc quidem praeter nos nemo est. dic mihi verum serio:
856 ecquis alius Sosia intust, qui mei similis siet?
857 Abin hinc a me dignus domino servos?
857b Abeo, si iubes.—
858 Nimis ecastor facinus mirum est, qui illi conlibitum siet
859 meo viro sic me insimulare falso facinus tam malum.
860 quidquid est, iam ex Naucrate cognato id cognoscam meo.—
853 If I have done wrong, there is no reason. 853b Agreed. Do you, Sosia, take these people in-doors. I'll bring Naucrates hither with me from the ship. 855 Now then, there's no one here except ourselves; tell me the truth seriously, is there any Sosia in-doors who is like myself? 857 Won't you hence away from me, fit servant for your master? 857b If you command me, I'm off , 858 By heavens, it is a very wondrous proceeding, how it has pleased this husband of mine thus to accuse me falsely of a crime so foul. 860 Whatever it is, I shall now learn it from my kinsman Naucrates.

3.1

861 Ego sum ille Amphitruo, cui est servos Sosia,
862 idem Mercurius qui fit, quando commodumst,
863 in superiore quí habito cenaculo,
864 qui interdum fio Iuppiter, quando lubet;
865 huc autem quom extemplo adventum adporto, ilico
866 Amphitruo fio et vestitum immuto meum.
867 nunc huc honoris vostri venio gratia,
868 ne hanc incohatam transigam comoediam;
869 simul Alcumenae, quam vir insontem probri
870 Amphitruo accusat, veni ut auxilium feram:
871 nam mea sit culpa, quod egomet contraxerim,
872 si id Alcumenae innocenti expetat.
873 nunc Amphitruonem memet, út occepi semel,
874 esse adsimulabo, atque in horum familiam
875 frustrationem hodie iniciam maxumam;
876 post igitur demum faciam res fiat palam
877 atque Alcumenae in tempore auxilium feram
878 faciamque ut uno fetu et quod gravida est viro
879 et me quod gravidast pariat sine doloribus.
880 Mercurium iussi me continuo consequi,
881 si quid vellem imperare. nunc hanc adloquar.
861 I am that Amphitryon, whose servant Sosia is the same that becomes Mercury when there is occasion—I, who dwell in the highest story, who sometimes, when it pleases me, become Jupiter. 865 But, hither soon as ever I turn my steps, I become Amphitryon that moment, and I change my garb. Now hither am I come for the sake of a compliment to you, that I may not leave this Comedy incomplete. I've come as well to bring assistance to Alcmena, whom, guiltless woman, her husband 870 Amphitryon is accusing of dishonor. For what I myself have brought about, if that undeservedly should fall as an injury upon her in

her innocence, it would be my blame. Now, as I have already begun, I’ll again pretend that I am Amphitryon, 875 and this day will I introduce extreme confusion into this household. Then afterwards, at last, I’ll cause the matter to be disclosed, and to Alcmena timely aid will I bring, and will cause that at one birth she shall bring forth, without pangs, both the child with which she is pregnant by her husband and that with which she is pregnant by myself. 880 I have ordered Mercury forthwith to follow me, if I should wish to give him any commands. Now will I accost her.

3.2.882

882 Durare nequeo in aedibus. ita me probri,
883 stupri, dedecoris a viro argutam meo!
884 ea quae sunt facta infecta ut reddat clamitat,
885 quae neque sunt facta neque ego in me admisi arguit;
886 atque id me susque deque esse habituram putat.
887 non edepol faciam, neque me perpetiar probri
888 falso insimulatam, quin ego illum aut deseram
889 aut sátis faciat mi ille átque adiuret insuper,
890 nolle esse dicta quae in me insontem protulit.
891 Faciundum est mi illud, fieri quód illaec postulat,
892 si me illam amantem ad sese studeam recipere,
893 quando ego quod feci, id factum Amphitruoni offuit
894 atque illi dudum meus amor negotium
895 insonti exhibuit, nunc autem insonti mihi
896 illius ira in hanc et male dicta expetent.
897 Sed eccum video qui me miseram arguit
898 stupri, dedecoris.
898b Te volo, uxor, conloqui.
899 quo te avortisti?
899b Ita ingenium meumst:
900 inimicos semper osa sum optuerier.
901 Heia autem inimicos?
901b Sic est, vera praedico;
902 nisi etiam hoc falso dici insimulaturus es.
903 Nimis iracunda es.
903b Potin ut abstineas manum?
904 nam certo, si sis sanus aut sapias satis,
905 quam tu impudicam esse arbitrere et praedices,
906 cum ea tú sermonem nec ioco nec serio
907 tibi habeas, nisi sis stultior stultissimo.
882 I cannot remain in the house. That I should be thus accused by my husband of dishonor, incontinence, and disgrace! he cries aloud that things which have been done, have really not been done; 885 and of things which have not been done, and of which I have not been guilty, he accuses me, and supposes that I shall treat it with indifference. By heavens, I will not do so, nor will I allow myself to be falsely charged with dishonor; but rather I’ll either leave him, or make him give satisfaction and swear as well 890 that he wishes unsaid the things which he has alleged against me in my innocence. 891 This must be done by me, which she requires to be done, if I wish for her to receive me into her company as loving her: since that which I have done, that same conduct has proved to the detriment of Amphitryon, and since my love has already created trouble for him who is really 895 guiltless, why now his wrath and his resentment towards her shall fall on me that am not accused. 897 And lo! I see him, who just now was accusing wretched me of

incontinence and dishonor. 898b Wife, I would discourse with you. (She turns from him.) Why turn yourself away? 899b Such is my disposition; 900 I always hate to look upon my enemies. 901 Heyday! enemies indeed! 901b It is so, I speak the truth; unless you are going to allege that this is falsely said as well. 903 You are too angry. 903b Can't you keep your hands off? For surely if you were wise, or quite in your senses, 905 with her, whom you deem and pronounce to be unchaste, you would neither hold discourse, in mirth or in seriousness, unless, indeed, you are more foolish than the most foolish. 908 If I did say so, not a bit the more are you so, nor do I think you so, and therefore have I returned hither that I might excuse myself to you. 910 For never has anything proved more grievous to my feelings than when I heard that you were angry with me. Why did you charge me? you will say. I'll tell you; by my troth, not that I deemed you to be unchaste; but I was trying your feelings, 915 what you would do, and in what manner you would bring yourself to bear it. Really, I said these things to you just now in jest, for the sake of the joke. Do but ask Sosia this. 918 But why don't you bring here my kinsman, Naucrates, whom you said just now that you would bring as a witness 920 that you had not come here? 920b If anything was said in joke, it isn't right for you to take it in earnest. 922 I know how much this has pained me at heart. 923 Prithee, Alcmena (taking her hand), by your right hand I do entreat you, grant me pardon; forgive me, don't be angry. 925 By my virtue have I rendered these accusations vain. Since then I eschew conduct that's unchaste, I would wish to avoid imputations of unchastity. Fare you well, keep your own property to yourself, return me mine. Do you order any maids to be my attendants? 929b Are you in your senses? 929c If you don't order them, 930 let me go alone; chastity shall I take as my attendant. 931 Stay—at your desire, I'll give my oath that I believe my wife to be chaste. If in that I deceive you, then, thee, supreme Jupiter, do I entreat that thou wilt ever be angered against Amphitryon. 935 Oh! rather may he prove propitious. 935b I trust that it will be so; for before you have I taken a truthful oath. Now then, you are not angry? 937b I am not. 937c You act properly. For in the life of mortals many things of this nature come to pass; and now they take their pleasures, again they meet with hardships. 940 Quarrels intervene, again do they become reconciled. But it perchance any quarrels of this nature happen between them, when again they have become reconciled, twofold more loving are they between themselves than they were before. 944 At the first you ought to have been careful not to say so; 945 but if you excuse yourself to me for the same, it must be put up with. 946 But bid the sacred vessels to be got ready for me, that I may fulfil all those vows which I made when with the army, in case I should return safe home. 949 I'll take care of that. 949b Call out Sosia hither. 950 Let him fetch Blepharo, the pilot that was on board my ship, to breakfast with us. (Aside.) He shall be fooled this day so as to go without his breakfast, while I shall drag Amphitryon hence by the throat. 954 It's surprising what he can be arranging alone in secrecy with himself. But the door opens; Sosia's coming out.

3.2.908

908 Si dixi, nihilo magis es, neque ego esse arbitror,
909 et id huc revorti uti me purgarem tibi.
910 nam numquam quicquam meo animo fuit aegrius,
911 quam postquam audivi ted esse iratam mihi.
912 cur dixisti? inquies. ego expediam tibi.
913 non edepol quo te esse impudicam crederem;
914 verum periclitatus súm animum tuom,
915 quid faceres et quo pacto id ferre induceres.
916 equidem ioco illa dixeram dudum tibi,
917 ridiculi causa. vél hunc rogato Sosiam.
918 Quin huc adducis meum cognatum Naucratem,

919 testem quem dudum te adducturum dixeras,
920 te huc non venisse?
920b Si quid dictum est per iocum,
921 non aequom est id te serio praevortier.
922 Ego illúd scio quam doluerit cordi meo.
923 Per dexteram tuam te, Alcumena, oro obsecro,
924 da mihi hanc veniam, ignosce, irata ne sies.
925 Ego istaec feci verba virtute irrita;
926 nunc, quando factis me impudicis abstini,
927 ab impudicis dictis avorti volo.
928 valeas, tibi habeas res tuas, reddas meas.
929 iuben mi íre comites?
929b Sanan es?
929c Si non iubes,
930 ibo egomet; comitem mihi Pudicitiam duxero.†
931 Mane. arbitratu tuo ius iurandum dabo,
932 me meam pudicam esse uxorem arbitrarier.
933 id ego si fallo, tum te, summe Iuppiter,
934 quaeso, Amphitruoni ut semper iratus sies.

3.2.935

935 A, propitius sit potius.
935b Confido fore;
936 nam ius iurandum verum te advorsum dedi.
937 iam nunc irata non es?
937b Non sum.
937c Bene facis.
938 nam in hominum aetate multa eveniunt huius modi:
939 capiunt voluptátes, capiunt rursum miserias;
940 irae interveniunt, redeunt rursum in gratiam.
941 verum irae si quae forte eveniunt huius modi
942 inter eos, rursum si reventum in gratiam est,
943 bis tanto amici sunt inter se quam prius.
944 Primum cavisse oportuit ne diceres,
945 verum eadem si isdem purgas mi, patiunda sunt.
946 Iube véro vasa pura adornari mihi,
947 ut quae ápud legionem vota vovi, si domum
948 rediissem salvos, ea ego exsolvam omnia.
949 Ego istuc curabo.
949b Evocate huc Sosiam;
950 gubernatorem qui in mea navi fuit
951 Blepharonem arcessat, qui nobiscum prandeat.
952 is adeo inpransus ludificabitur,
953 cum ego Amphitruonem collo hinc obstricto traham.
954 Mirum quid solus secum secreto ille agat.
955 atque aperiuntur aedes. exit Sosia.

3.3

956 Ámphitruo, assum. sí quid opus est, impera, imperium éxequar.
957 Sosia, optume advenis.

957b Iam pax est inter vos duos?
958 nam quia vos tranquillos video, gaudeo et volup est mihi.
959 atque ita servom par videtur frugi sese instituere:
960 proinde eri ut sint, ipse item sit; voltum e voltu comparet:
961 tristis sit, si eri sint tristes; hilarus sit, si gaudeant.
962 sed age responde: iam vos rediistis in concordiam?
963 Derides, qui scis haec dudum me dixisse per iocum.
964 An id ioco dixisti? équidem serio ac vero ratus.
965 Habui expurigationem; facta pax est.
965b Optume est.
966 Ego rem divinam intus faciam, vota quae sunt.
966b Censeo.
967 Tu gubernatorem a navi huc evoca verbis meis
968 Blepharonem, qui re divina facta mecum prandeat.
969 Iam hic ero, cum illic censebis esse me.—
969b Actutum huc redi.
970 Numquid vis, quin abeam iam intro, ut apparentur quibus opust?
971 I sane, et quantum potest parata fac sint omnia.
972 Quin venis quando vis intro? faxo haud quicquam sit morae.—
973 Recte loquere et proinde diligentem ut uxorem decet.
974 iam hisce ambo, et servos et era, frustra sunt duo,
975 qui me Amphitruonem rentur esse: errant probe.
976 nunc tu divine húc fac adsis Sosia
977 (audis quae dico, tam etsi praesens non ades),
978 fac Amphitruonem ádvenientem ab aedibus
979 ut abigas; quovis pacto fac commentus sis.
980 volo déludi illunc, dum cum hac usuraria
981 uxore nunc mihi morigero. haec curata sint
982 fac sis, proinde adeo ut velle med intellegis,
983 atque ut ministres mihi, mihi cum sacruficem.
956 Amphitryon, I’m here; if any way you have need of me, command me; your commands I will obey. 957 Very opportunely are you come. 957b Has peace been made then between you two? But since I see you in good humour, I’m delighted, and it is a pleasure to myself. And so does it seem becoming for a trusty servant to conduct himself; 960 just as his superiors are, so should he be likewise; by their countenances he should fashion his own countenance; if his superiors are grave, let him be grave; if they rejoice, let him be merry. But come, answer me; have you two now come to a reconciliation? 963 You are laughing at me, who know full well that these things were just now said by me in joke. 964 In joke did you say it? For my part, I supposed that it was said seriously and in truthfulness. 965 Still, I’ve made my excuses; and peace has been made. 965b ’Tis very good. 966 I shall now perform the sacrifice in-doors, and the vows which I have made. 966b So I suppose. 967 Do you invite hither, in my name, Blepharo, the pilot, from the ship, so that when the sacrifice has been performed, he may breakfast with me. 969 I shall be here again, while you’ll be thinking that I’m there. 969b Return here directly. 970 Do you wish for anything else, but that I should go in-doors now, that the things that are requisite may be got ready? 971 Go then, and take care that everything is prepared as soon as possible. 972 Why, come in-doors whenever you please; I’ll take care that there shall not be any delay. 973 You say well, and just as befits an attentive wife. (ALCMENA goes into the house.) Now both of these, both servant and mistress, are, the pair of them, deceived, 975 in taking me to be Amphitryon; egregiously do they err. Now, you immortal Sosia, take you care and be at hand for me. You hear what I say, although you are not present here. Take care that you

contrive to drive away Amphitryon, on his arrival just now, by some means or other, from the house. 980 I wish him to be cajoled, while with this borrowed wife I now indulge myself. Please, take care that this is attended to just in such way as you know that I desire, and that you assist me while to myself I am offering sacrifice.

3.4

984 Concédite atque abscédite omnes, dé via decédite,
985 nec quísquam tam audax fúat homo, qui óbviam obsistát mihi.
986 nam mihi quidem hercle qui minus liceat deo minitarier
987 populo, ni decedat mihi, quam servolo in comoediis?
988 ille návem salvam nuntiat aut irati adventum senis:
989 ego sum Iovi dicto audiens, eius iussu nunc huc me adfero.
990 quam ob rem mihi magis par est via decedere et concedere.
991 pater vocat me, eum sequor, eius dicto imperio sum audiens;
992 ut filium bonum patri esse oportet, itidem ego sum patri.
993 amanti subparasitor, hortor, adsto, admoneo, gaudeo.
994 si quid patri volup est, voluptas ea mi multo maxumast.
995 amat: sapit; recte facit, animo quando obsequitur suo,
996 quod omnis homines facere oportet, dum id modo fiat bono.
997 nunc Amphitruonem volt deludi meus pater: faxo probe
998 iam hic deludetur, spectatores, vobis inspectantibus.
999 capiam coronam mi in caput, adsimulabo me esse ebrium;
1000 atque illuc sursum escendero: inde optume aspellam virum
1001 de supero, cum huc accesserit; faciam ut sit madidus sobrius.
1002 deinde illi actutum sufferet suos servos poenas Sosia:
1003 eum fécisse ille hodie arguet quae ego feceró hic. quid mea?
1004 meo me aéquomst morigerum patri, eius studio servire addecet.
1005 sed eccum Amphitruonem, advenit; iam ille hic deludetur probe,
1006 siquidém vos voltis auscultando operam dare.
1007 ibo intro, ornatum capiam qui potis decet;
1008 dein susum ascendam in tectum, ut illum hinc prohibeam.
984 Stand by and make room all of you, get you out of the way. 985 And let not any person now be so presumptuous as to stand before me in the road. For surely, why, by my troth, should I, a God, be any less allowed to threaten the public, if it does not get out of my way, than a slave in Comedies? He is bringing news that the ship is safe, or else the approach of some angry old blade; whereas I am obeying the bidding of Jove, and by his command do I now hie me. 990 For this reason, it is more fitting to get out of the road and to make room for me. My father calls me, I am following him, to his orders so given am I obedient. As it befits a son to be dutiful to his father, just so am I to my father; in his amours I play second fiddle to him, I encourage him, assist him, advise him, rejoice with him. If anything is pleasing to my father, that pleasure is an extremely great one for myself. 995 Is he amorously disposed? He is wise; he does right, inasmuch as he follows his inclination; a thing that all men ought to do, so long as it is done in a proper manner. Now, my father wishes Amphitryon to be cajoled; I'll take care, Spectators, that he shall be rarely cajoled, while you look on. I'll place a chaplet on my head, and pretend that I am drunk. 1000 And up there (pointing to the top of the house) will I get; from that spot, at the top of the house, I'll cleverly drive this person off when he comes hither: I'll take care that, sober, he shall be drenched. Afterwards, his own servant Sosia will presently be suffering the punishment for it; he'll be accusing him of doing, this day, the things which I myself have done what's that to me? It's proper for me to be obedient to my father; it's right to be subservient to his pleasure. 1005 But see! here is Amphitryon; he's coming. Now shall he be rarely fooled, if,

indeed, (to the AUDIENCE) you are willing, by listening, to lend your attention. I'll go indoors, and assume a garb that more becomes me; then I'll go up upon the roof, that I may drive him off from hence.

4.1

1009 Naúcratem quem cónvenire vólui, in navi nón erat,
1010 neque domi neque in urbe invenio quemquam qui illum viderit.
1011 nam omnis plateas perreptavi, gymnasia et myropolia;
1012 apud emporium atque in macello, ín palaestra atque in foro,
1013 in medicinis, in tonstrinis, apud omnis aedis sacras
1014 sum defessus quaeritando: nusquam invenio Naucratem.
1015 nunc domum ibo atque ex uxore hánc rem pergam exquirere,
1016 quis fuerit quem propter corpus suom stupri compleverit.
1017 nam me, quam illam quaestionem inquisitam hodie amittere,
1018 mortuom satiust. sed aedis occluserunt. eugepae,
1019 pariter hoc fit atque ut alia facta sunt. feriam foris.
1020 aperite hoc. heus, ecquis hic est? ecquis hoc aperit ostium?
1009 Naucrates, whom I wanted to find, was not on board ship; 1010 neither at home nor in the city do I meet with any one that has seen him; for through all the streets have I crawled, the wrestling-rings and the perfumers' shops, to the market, too, and in the shambles, the school for exercise, and the Forum, the doctors' shops, the barbers' shops, and among all the sacred buildings. I'm wearied out with seeking him, and yet I nowhere meet with Naucrates. 1015 Now I'll go home, and from my wife will I continue to make enquiry into this matter, who the person was, by the side of whom she submitted her body to dishonor. For it were better that I was dead, than that I this day should leave this enquiry incomplete. (Goes up to the door.) But the house is closed. A pretty thing indeed! This is done just like the other things have been done: I'll knock at the door. (Knocks.) 1020 Open this door; ho there! is there anybody here? Is any one going to open this door?

4.2.1021

1021 Quís ad fores est?
1021b Égo sum.
1021c Quid ego sum.
1021d Íta loquor.
1021e Tibi Iúppiter
1022 dique omnes irati certo sunt, qui sic frangas fores.
1023 Quo modo?
1023b Eo modo, ut profecto vivas aetatem miser.
1024 Sosia.
1024b Ita, sum Sosia, nisi me esse oblitum existimas.
1025 quid nunc vis?
1025b Sceleste, at etiam quid velim, id tu me rogas?
1026 Ita, rogo. paene effregisti, fatue, foribus cardines.
1027 an foris censebas nobis publicitus praeberier?
1028 quid me aspectas, stolide? quid nunc vis tibi? aut quis tu es homo?
1029 Verbero, etiam quis ego sim me rogitas, ulmorum Acheruns?
1030 quem pol ego hodie ob istaec dicta faciam ferventem flagris.
1031 Prodigum te fuisse oportet olim in adulescentia.
1032 Quidum?
1032b Quia senecta aetate á me mendicas malum.

1033 Cum cruciatu tuo istaec hodie, verna, verba funditas.
1034 Sacrufico ego tibi.
1034b Qui?
1034c Quia enim te macto infortunio.
1034_frg1 At ego te cruce et cruciatu mactabo, mastigia.
1034_frg2 Érus Amphitruost occupatus.
1034_frg3 abiendi nunc tibi etiam occasiost.
1034_frg4 Optimo iure infringatur aula cineris in caput.
1034_frg5 Ne tu postules matulam unam tibi aquae ínfundi in caput.
1034_frg6 Laruatu's laruatus es . edepol hominem miserum. medicum quaerita.
1021 Who’s that at the door? 1021b ’Tis I. 1021c Who’s ’tis I? 1021d ’Tis I that say so. 1021e For sure, Jupiter and all the Deities are angered with you who are banging at the door this way. 1023 In what manner? 1023b In this manner, that without a doubt you must be spending a wretched life. 1024 Sosia. 1024b Well; I’m Sosia, unless you think that I’ve forgotten myself. 1025 What do you want now? 1025b What, you rascal, and do you even ask me that, what it is I want? 1026 I do so ask you; you blockhead, you’ve almost broken the hinges from off the door. Did you fancy that doors were supplied us at the public charge? Why are you looking up at me, you stupid? What do you want now for yourself, or what fellow are you? 1029 You whip-scoundrel, do you even ask me who I am, you hell of elm-saplings? 1030 I’ faith, this day I’ll make you burn with smarts of the scourge for these speeches of yours. 1031 You surely must have formerly been a spendthrift in your young days. 1032 How so? 1032b Because in your old age you come begging a hap-ill of me for yourself. 1033 Slave! for your own torture do you give vent to these expressions this day. 1034 Now I’m performing a sacrifice to you. 1034b How? 1034c Why, because I devote you to ill-luck with this libation. 1034_sp1 What, you, devote me, you villain? If the Gods have not this day taken away my usual form, I’ll take care that you shall be laden with bull’s hide thongs, you victim of Saturn. So surely will I devote you to the cross and to torture. Come out of doors, you whip-knave. 1034_sp2 You shadowy ghost—you, frighten me with your threats? If you don’t betake yourself off from here this instant, if you knock once more, if the door makes a noise with your little finger even, I’ll break your head with this tile, so that with your teeth you may sputter out your tongue. 1034_sp3 What, rascal, would you be for driving me away from my own house? What, would you hinder me from knocking at my own door? I’ll this instant tear it from off all its hinges. 1034_sp4 Do you persist? 1034_sp5 I do persist. 1034_sp6 Take that, then. 1034_sp7 Scoundrel! at your master? If I lay hands upon you this day, I’ll bring you to that pitch of misery, that you shall be miserable for evermore. 1034_sp8 Surely, you must have been playing the Bacchanal, old gentleman. 1034_sp9 Why so?

4.2.1034_frg7

1034_frg7 Exiúravisti te mihi dixe per iocum.
1034_frg8 Quaeso advenienti morbo medicari iube:
1034_frg8a tu certe aut laruatus aut cerritus es.
1034_frg9 Nisi hoc ita factum est, proinde ut factum esse autumo,
1034_frg9a non causam dico quin vero insimules probri
1034_frg10 Cuius? quaé me absente corpus volgavit suom.
1034_frg11 Quíd minitabas te facturum, si istas pepulissem fores?
1034_frg12 Ibi scrobes ecfodito tu plus sexagenos in die.
1034_frg13 Noli pessimo precari.
1034_frg14 animam comprime
1034_frg15 Mánifestum hunc optorto collo teneo furem flagiti.
1034_frg16 Immo ego hunc, Thebani cives, qui domi uxorem meam

1034_frg16a impudicitia impedivit, teneo, thensaurum stupri.
1034_frg17 Nilne te pudet, sceleste, populi in conspectum ingredi?
1034_frg18 clandestino
1034_frg19 Qui nequeas nostrorum uter sit Amphitruo decernere.
1034_sp10 Inasmuch as you take me to be your slave. 1034_sp11 What? I—take you? 1034_sp12 Plague upon you! I know no master but Amphitryon. 1034_sp13 Have I lost my form? It's strange that Sosia shouldn't know me. I'll make trial. (Calling out.) How now! Tell me who I appear to be? Am I not really Amphitryon? 1034_sp14 Amphitryon? Are you in your senses? Has it not been told you before, old fellow, that you have been playing the Bacchanal, to be asking another person who you are? Get away, I recommend you, don't be troublesome while Amphitryon, who has just come back from the enemy, is indulging himself with the company of his wife. 1034_sp15 What wife? 1034_sp16 Alcmena. 1034_sp17 What man? 1034_sp18 How often do you want it told? Amphitryon, my master;—don't be troublesome. 1034_sp19 Who's he sleeping with? 1034_sp20 Take care that you don't meet with some mishap in trifling with me this way. 1034_sp21 Prithee, do tell me, my dear Sosia. 1034_sp22 More civilly said—with Alcmena. 1034_sp23 In the same chamber? 1034_sp24 Yes, as I fancy, he is sleeping with her side by side. 1034_sp25 Alas!—wretch that I am! 1034_sp26 It really is a gain which he imagines to be a misfortune. For to lend one's wife to another is just as though you were to let out barren land to be ploughed. 1034_sp27 Sosia! 1034_sp28 What, the plague, about Sosia? 1034_sp29 Don't you know me, you whip-scoundrel? 1034_sp30 I know that you are a troublesome fellow, who have no need to go buy a lawsuit. 1034_sp31 Still once more—am I not your master Amphitryon? 1034_sp32 You are Bacchus himself, and not Amphitryon. How often do you want to be told? Any times more? My master Amphitryon, in the same chamber, is holding Alcmena in his embraces. If you persist, I'll produce him here, and not without your great discomfiture. 1034_sp33 I wish him to be fetched. (Aside.) I pray that this day, in return for my services, I may not lose house, wife, and household, together with my figure. 1034_sp34 Well, I'll fetch him; but, in the meantime, do you mind about the door, please. (Aside.) I suppose that by this he has brought the sacrifice that he was intending, as far as the banquet. (Aloud.) If you are troublesome, you shan't escape without my making a sacrifice of you. 1034_sp35 Ye Gods, by my trust in you, what madness is distracting my household? What wondrous things have I seen since I arrived from abroad! Why, it's true, surely, what was once heard tell of, how that men of Attica were transformed in Arcadia, and remained as savage wild beasts, and were not ever afterwards known unto their parents. 1034_sp36 What's this, Sosia? Great marvels are these that you are telling of. Do you say that you found another Sosia at home exactly like yourself? 1034_sp37 I do say so—but, hark you, since I have produced a Sosia, Amphitryon an Amphitryon, how do you know whether you, perchance, may not be producing another Blepharo? O that the Gods would grant that you as well, belaboured with fists, and with your teeth knocked out, going without your breakfast, might credit this. ForI, that other Sosia, that is to say, who am yonder, has mauled me in a dreadful manner. 1034_sp38 Really, it is wonderful; but it's as well to mend our pace; for, as I perceive, Amphitryon is waiting for us, and my empty stomach is grumbling. 1034_sp39 —And why do I mention foreign legends? More wondrous things they relate to have happened among our Theban race in former days; that mighty searcher for Europa, attacking the monster sprung from Mars, suddenly produced his enemies from the serpent-seed; and in that battle fought, brother pressed on brother with lance and helm; the Epirote land, too, beheld the author of our race, together with the daughter of Venus, gliding as serpents. From on high supreme Jove thus willed it; thus destiny directs. All the noblest of our country, in return for their bright achievements, are pursued with direful woes. This fatality is pressing hard on me—still I could endure disasters so great, and submit to woes hardly to be endured—
1034_sp40 Blepharo. 1034_sp41 What's the matter? 1034_sp42 I don't know; I suspect

something wrong. 1034_sp43 Why? 1034_sp44 Look, please, our master, like an humble courtier, is walking before the door bolted fast. 1034_sp45 It’s nothing; walking to and fro, he’s looking for an appetite. 1034_sp46 After a singular fashion, indeed; for he has shut the door, that it mayn’t escape out of the house. 1034_sp47 You do go yelping on. 1034_sp48 I go neither yelping on nor barking on; if you listen to me, observe him. I don’t know why he’s by himself alone; he’s making some calculation, I suppose. I can hear from this spot what he says— don’t be in a hurry. 1034_sp49 How much I fear lest the Gods should blot out the glory I have acquired in the conquest of the foe. In wondrous manner do I see the whole of my household in commotion. And then my wife, so full of viciousness, incontinence, and dishonor, kills me outright. But about the goblet, it is a singular thing; yet the seal was properly affixed. And what besides? She recounted to me the battles I had fought; Pterelas, too, besieged and bravely slain by my own hand, Aye, aye—now I know the trick; this was done by Sosia’s contrivance, who as well has disgracefully presumed to-day to get before me on my arrival. 1034_sp50 He’s talking about me, and in terms that I had rather not. Prithee, don’t let’s accost this man until he has disclosed his wrath. 1034_sp51 Just as you please. 1034_sp52 If it is granted me this day to lay hold of that whip-scoundrel, I’ll show him what it is to deceive his master, and to assail me with threats and tricks. 1034_sp53 Do you hear him? 1034_sp54 I hear him. 1034_sp55 That implement (pointing to AMPHITRYON’S walkingstick) is a burden for my shoulder-blades. Let’s accost the man, if you please. Do you know what is in the habit of being commonly said? 1034_sp56 What you are going to say, I don’t know; what you’ll have to endure I pretty well guess. 1034_sp57 It’s an old adage—Hunger and delay summon anger to the nostrils. 1034_sp58 Aye, and well suited to the occasion. Let’s address him directly—Amphitryon! 1034_sp59 Is it Blepharo I hear? It’s strange why he’s come to me. Still, he presents himself opportunely, for me to prove the guilty conduct of my wife. Why have you come here to me, Blepharo? 1034_sp60 Have you so soon forgotten how early in the morning you sent Sosia to the ship, that I might take a repast with you to-day? 1034_sp61 Never in this world was it done. But where is that scoundrel? 1034_sp62 Who? 1034_sp63 Sosia. 1034_sp64 See, there he is. 1034_sp65 Where? BLEPH. Before your eyes; don’t you see him? 1034_sp66 I can hardly see for anger, so distracted has that fellow made me this day. You shall never escape my making a sacrifice of you. (Offers to strike SOSIA, on which BLEPHARO prevents him.) Do let me, Blepharo. 1034_sp67 Listen, I pray. 1034_sp68 Say on, I’m listening— (gives a blow to SOSIA) you take that. 1034_sp69 For what reason? Am I not in good time? I couldn’t have gone quicker, if I had betaken myself on the oar-like wings of Daedalus. 1034_sp70 Prithee, do leave him alone; we couldn’t quicken our pace any further. 1034_sp71 Whether it was the pace of a man on stilts or that of the tortoise, I’m determined to be the death of this villain. (Striking him at each sentence.) Take that for the roof; that for the tiles; that for closing the door; that for making fun of your master; that for your abusive language. 1034_sp72 What injury has he been doing to you? 1034_sp73 Do you ask? Shut out of doors, from that housetop (pointing to it) he has driven me away from my house. 1034_sp74 What, I? 1034_sp75 What did you threaten that you would do if I knocked at that door? Do you deny it, you scoundrel? 1034_sp76 Why shouldn’t I deny it? See, he’s sufficiently a witness with whom I have just now come; I was sent on purpose that by your invitation I might bring him to your house. 1034_sp77 Who sent you, villain? 1034_sp78 He who asks me the question. 1034_sp79 When, of all things? 1034_sp80 Some little time since-not long since—just now. When you were reconciled at home to your wife. 1034_sp81 Bacchus must have demented you. 1034_sp82 May I not be paying my respects to Bacchus this day, nor yet to Ceres. You ordered the vessels to be made clean, that you might perform a sacrifice, and you sent me to fetch him (pointing to BLEPHARO), that he might breakfast with you. 1034_sp83 Blepharo, may I perish outright if I have either been in the house, or if I have sent him. (To SOSIA.) Tell me—where did you leave me? 1034_sp84 At home, with your wife

Alcmena. Leaving you, I flew towards the harbour, and invited him in your name. We are come, and I’ve not seen you since till now. 1034_sp85 Villanous fellow! With my wife, say you? You shall never go away without getting a beating. 1034_sp86 Blepharo! 1034_sp87 Amphitryon, do let him alone, for my sake, and listen to me. 1034_sp88 Well then, I’ll let him alone. What do you want? Say on. 1034_sp89 He has just now been telling me most extraordi nary marvels. A juggler, or a sorcerer, perhaps, has enchanted all this household of yours. Do enquire in other quarters, and examine how it is. And don’t cause this poor fellow to be tortured, before you understand the matter. 1034_sp90 You give good advice; let’s go in, I want you also to be my advocate against my wife.

4.3

1035 Vós inter vos partite; ego abeo, mihi negotium est;
1036 neque ego umquam usquam tanta mira me vidisse censeo.
1037 Blepharo, quaeso ut advocatus mi adsis neve abeas.
1037b Vale.
1038 quid opust me advocato, quí utri sim advocatus nescio?—
1039 Intro ego hinc eo. Alcumena parturit.—
1039b Perii miser.
1040 quid ego faciam, quem advocati iam atque amici deserunt?
1041 numquam edepol me inultus istic ludificabit, quisquis est;
1042 nam iam ad regem recta me ducam resque ut facta est eloquar.†
1043 ego pol illum ulciscar hodie Thessalum veneficum,
1044 qui pervorse perturbavit familiae mentem meae.
1045 sed ubi illest? intro edepol abiit, credo ad uxorem meam.
1046 qui me Thebis alter vivit miserior? quid nunc agam,
1047 quem omnes mortales ignorant et ludificant ut lubet.
1048 certumst, intro rumpam in aedis: ubi quemque hominem aspexero,
1049 si ancillam seu servom sive uxorem sive adulterum
1050 seu patrem sive ávom videbo, óbtruncabo in aedibus.
1051 neque me Iuppiter neque di omnes id prohibebunt, si volent,
1052 quin sic faciam ut constitui. pergam in aedis nunciam.
1035 Do you settle these matters between yourselves; I’m off, for I have business; and I do not think that I have ever anywhere beheld such extraordinary wonders. 1037 Blepharo, I pray that you’ll stay as my advocate, and not go away. 1037b Farewell. What need is there of me for an advocate, who don’t know which of the two to side with? 1039 I’m going hence in-doors: Alcmena is in labour. 1039b I’m undone, wretch that I am; 1040 for what am I to do, when my advocates and friends are now forsaking me? Never, by heavens, shall he deride me unrevenged, whoever he is. Now will I betake myself straight to the king, and tell him of the matter as it has happened. By my faith, I will this day take vengeance on this Thessalian sorcerer, who has wrongfully distracted the minds of my household. 1045 But where is he? (Looking around.) By my troth, he’s off into the house, to my wife, I suppose. What other person lives in Thebes more wretched than myself? What now shall I do? I, whom all men deny and deride just as they please. I am resolved; I’ll burst into the house; there, whatever person I perceive, whether maid-servant or man-servant, whether wife or whether paramour, 1050 whether father or whether grandfather, I’ll behead that person in the house; neither Jupiter nor all the Deities shall hinder me from this, even if they would, but that I’ll do just as I have resolved.

5.1.1053

1053 Spes átque opes vitaé meae iacént sepultae in pectore,

1054 neque ullast confidentia iam in corde, quin amiserim;
1055 ita mihi videntur omnia, mare terra caelum, consequi,
1056 iam ut opprimar, ut enicer. me miseram, quid agam nescio.
1057 ita tanta mira in aedibus sunt facta. vae miserae mihi,
1058 animo malest, aquam velim. corrupta sum atque absumpta sum.
1059 caput dolet, neque audio, nec oculis prospicio satis,
1060 nec me miserior femina est neque ulla videatur magis.
1061 ita erae meae hodie contigit. nam ubi parturit, deos síbi invocat,
1062 strepitús, crepitus, sonitús, tonitrus: ut subito, ut propere, ut valide tonuit!
1063 ubi quísque institerat, cóncidit crepitu. íbi nescio quis máxuma
1064 vóce exclamat: “Alcumena, adest auxilium, ne time:
1065 et tibi et tuis propitius caeli cultor advenit.
1066 exsúrgite” inquit qui terrore meo occidistis prae metu.
1067 ut iácui, exsurgo. ardére censui aédis, ita tum cónfulgebant.
1068 íbi me inclamat Álcumena; iam éa res me horrore ádficit,
1069 erílis praevertít metus: accúrro, ut sciscam quíd velit.
1070 atque illam geminos filios pueros peperisse conspicor;
1071 neque nostrum quisquam sensimus, quom peperit, neque providimus.
1072 séd quid hoc? quis hicést senex, qui ante aédis nostras síc iacet?
1073 numnam húnc percussit Iúppiter?
1074 credo édepol, nam, pro Iúppiter, sepúltust quasi sit mórtuos.
1075 ibo et cognoscam, quisquis est. Amphitruo híc quidem est érus meus.
1076 Amphítruo.
1076b Perii.
1076c Súrge.
1076d Interii.
1076e Cédo manum.
1076f Quis mé tenet?
1077 Tua Bromia ancilla.
1053 The hopes and resources of my life lie buried in my breast, nor is there any boldness in my heart, but what I have lost it. 1055 So much to me do all things seem, the sea, the earth, the heavens, to be conspiring, that now I may be crushed, that I may be destroyed. Ah, wretched me! I know not what to do. Prodigies so great have come to pass within the house. Ah! woe is me! I’m sick at heart, some water I could wish! I’m overpowered and I’m utterly undone. My head is aching, and I cannot hear, nor do I see well with my eyes. 1060 No woman is there more wretched than myself, nor can one seem to be more so. Thus has it this day befallen my mistress; for when she invoked for herself the Deities of travail, what rumblings and grumblings, crashes and flashes; suddenly, how instantaneously did it thunder, and how woundy loud. On the spot where each one stood, at the peal he fell; then some one, I know not who, exclaimed in a mighty voice, Alcmena, succour is at hand, fear not: 1065 propitious both to thee and thine, the Ruler of the Heavens comes. Arise, it said, ye who have fallen down in your terror through dread of me. As I lay, I arose; I fancied that the house was in flames. Then Alcmena called me; and then did that circumstance strike me with horror. Fears for my mistress took possession of me; I ran to her to enquire what she wanted; 1070 and then I beheld that she had given birth to two male children; not yet did any one of us perceive when she was delivered, or indeed expect it. (Sees AMPHITRYON.) But what’s this? Who’s this old man that’s lying thus before our house? Has Jupiter then smitten him with his thunders? By my troth, I think so; for, oh Jupiter! he is in a lethargy just like one dead. 1075 I’ll approach, that I may learn who it is. (She advances.) Surely, this is my master Amphitryon. (Calls aloud.) Ho! Amphitryon! 1076b I’m dead. 1076c Arise. 1076d I’m slain outright. 1076e Give me your hand. 1076f Who is it that has hold of me?

1077 Bromia, your maid-servant. 1077b I tremble all over, to such a degree has Jove pealed against me. And no otherwise is it than if I had come hither from Acheron. But why have you come out of the house? 1097b The same alarm has scared ourselves, affrighted with horror; 1080 in the house where you yourself dwell, have I seen astounding prodigies. Woe to me, Amphitryon; even now do my senses fail me to such a degree. 1081b Come now, tell me; do you know me to be your master Amphitryon? 1082b I do know it. 1082c Look even once again. 1082d I do know it. 1083 She alone of all my household has a sane mind. 1084 Nay but, really, they are all of them sane. 1084b But my wife causes me to be insane 1085 by her own shameful practices. 1085b But I'll make you, Amphitryon, to be holding other language; that you may understand that your wife is dutiful and chaste, upon that subject I will in a few words discover some tokens and some proofs. In the first place of all, Alcmena has given birth to two sons. 1089 Two, say you? 1089b Two. 1089c The Gods preserve me! 1089d Allow me to speak, 1090 that you may know that all the Deities are propitious to yourself and to your wife. 1091 Say on.

5.1.1077b

1077b Totus timeo, íta me increpuit Iuppiter.
1078 nec secus est, quasi si ab Acherunte veniam. sed quid tu foras
1079 egressa es?
1079b Eadem nos formido timidas terrore impulit
1080 in aedibus, tu ubi habitas. nimia mira vidi. vae mihi,
1081 Amphitruo, íta mihi animus etiam nunc abest.
1081b Agedum expedi:
1082 scin me tuom esse erum Amphitruonem?
1082b Scio.
1082c Vide etiam nunc.
1082d Scio.
1083 Haec sola sanam mentem gestat meorum familiarium.
1084 Immo omnes sani sunt profecto.
1084b At me uxor insanum facit
1085 suis foedis factis.
1085b At ego faciam, tu idem ut aliter praedices,
1086 Ámphitruo, piam et pudicam ésse tuam uxorem ut scias.
1087 de ea re signa atque argumenta paucis verbis eloquar.
1088 omnium primum: Alcumena geminos peperit filios.
1089 Ain tu, geminos?
1089b Geminos.
1089c Di me servant.
1089d Sine me dicere,
1090 ut scias tibi tuaeque uxori deos esse omnis propitios.
1091 Loquere.
1091b Postquam parturire hodie uxor occepit tua,
1092 ubi utero exorti dolores, ut solent puerperae
1093 invocat deos immortales, ut sibi auxilium ferant,
1094 manibus puris, capite operto. íbi continuo contonat
1095 sonitu maxumo; aedes primo ruere rebamur tuas.
1091b After that, this day, your wife began to be in labour, when the pangs of childbirth came on, as is the custom with women in travail, she invoked the immortal Gods to give her aid, with washed hands and with covered head. Then forthwith it thundered 1095 with most tremendous crash. At first we thought that your house was falling; all your house shone bright, as though it had been made of gold. 1097 Prithee, relieve me quickly from this,

since you have kept me long enough in suspense. What happened then? 1098b While these things were passing, meanwhile, not one of us heard your wife groaning or complaining; 1100 and thus, in fact, without pain was she delivered. 1100b Then do I rejoice at this, whatever she has merited at my hands. 1101b Leave that alone, and hear these things which I shall tell you. After she was delivered, she bade us wash the babes; we commenced to do so. But that child which I washed, how stout, how very powerful he is; and not a person was there, able to wrap him in the swaddling-clothes. 1105 Most wondrous things you tell of. If these things are true, I do not apprehend but that succour has been brought to my wife from heaven. 1107 Now shall I make you own to things more wondrous still. After he was laid in the cradle, two immense crested serpents glided down through the skylight; instantly they both reared their heads. 1109b Ah me! 1110 Be not dismayed—but the serpents began to gaze upon all around. After they beheld the children, quickly they made towards the cradle; I, fearing for the children, alarmed for myself, going backwards, began to draw and pull the cradle to and fro, and so much the more fiercely did the serpents pursue. After that one of the children caught sight of the serpents, 1115 he quickly leapt from the cradle, straightway he made an attack upon them, ana suddenly he grasped them, one in each hand. 1117 You tell of wondrous things; a very fearful exploit do you relate; for at your words horror steals upon the limbs of wretched me. What happened then? Say on. 1119b The child slew both the serpents. While these things are passing, in a loud voice there calls upon your wife— 1121 What person—? 1121b Jupiter, the supreme Ruler of Gods and men. He said that he had secretly enjoyed Alcmena in his embraces, and that he was his own son who had overcome those serpents; the other, he said, was your child. 1124b By my troth, I am not sorry 1125 if I am allowed to take my half of a blessing in partnership with Jupiter. Go home, and bid the sacred vessels to be at once prepared for me, that with many victims I may seek my peace with supreme Jove. I will apply to Tiresias the soothsayer, and consult him what he considers ought to be done; at the same time I’ll relate to him this matter just as it has happened. (It thunders.) 1130 But what means this? How dreadfully it thunders! Ye Gods, your mercy, I do entreat.

5.1.1096

1096 aedes totae confulgebant tuae, quasi essent aureae.
1097 Quaeso absolvito hinc me extemplo, quando satis deluseris.
1098 quid fit deinde?
1098b Dum haec aguntur, interea uxorem tuam
1099 neque gementem neque plorantem nostrum quisquam audivimus;
1100 ita profecto sine dolore peperit.
1100b Iam istuc gaudeo,
1101 utut erga me merita est.
1101b Mitte ista atque haec quae dicam accipe.
1102 postquam peperit, pueros lavere iussit nos. occepimus.
1103 sed puer ille quém ego lavi, ut magnust et multum valet!
1104 neque eum quisquam colligare quivit incunabulis.
1105 Nimia mira memoras; si istaec vera sunt, divinitus
1106 non metuo quin méae uxori latae suppetiae sient.
1107 Magis iam faxo mira dices. postquam in cunas conditust,
1108 devolant angues iubati deorsum in impluvium duo
1109 maximi: continuo extollunt ambo capita.
1109b Ei mihi.
1110 Ne pave. sed angues oculis omnis circumvisere.
1111 postquam pueros conspicati, pergunt ad cunas citi.
1112 ego cunas recessim rursum vorsum trahere et ducere,

1113 metuens pueris, mihi formidans; tantoque angues acrius
1114 persequi. postquam conspexit angues ille alter puer,
1115 citus e cunis exilit, facit recta in anguis impetum:
1116 alterum altera prehendit eos manu perniciter.
1117 Mira memoras, nimis formidolosum facinus praedicas;
1118 nam mihi horror membra misero percipit dictis tuis.
1119 quid fit deinde? porro loquere.
1119b Puer ambo angues enicat.
1120 dum haec aguntur, voce clara exclamat uxorem tuam—

5.1.1121

1121 Quis homo?
1121b Summus imperator divom atque hominum Iuppiter.
1122 is se dixit cum Alcumena clam consuetum cubitibus,
1123 eumque filium suom esse qui illos angues vicerit;
1124 alterum tuom esse dixit puerum.
1124b Pol me haud paenitet,
1125 si licet boni dimidium mihi dividere cum Iove.
1126 abi domum, iube vasa pura actutum adornari mihi,
1127 ut Iovis supremi multis hostiis pacem expetam.
1128 ego Teresiam coniectorem ádvocabo et consulam
1129 quid faciundum censeat; simul hanc rem ut facta est eloquar.
1130 sed quid hoc? quam valide tonuit. di, obsecro vostram fidem.

5.2

1131 Bono ánimo es, adsum auxílio, Amphitruo, tíbi et tuis:
1132 nihil est quod timeas. hariolos, haruspices
1133 mitte omnes; quae futura et quae facta eloquar,
1134 multo adeo melius quam illi, quom sum Iuppiter.
1135 primum omnium Alcumenae usuram corporis
1136 cepi, et concubitu gravidam feci filio.
1137 tu gravidam item fecisti, cúm in exercitum
1138 profectu's profectus es : uno partu duos peperit simul.
1139 eorum alter, nostro qui est susceptus semine,
1140 suis factis te immortali adficiet gloria.
1141 tu cum Alcumena uxore antiquam in gratiam
1142 redi: haud promeruit quam ob rem vitio vorteres;
1143 mea vi subactast facere. ego in caelum migro.—
1144 Fáciam ita ut iubés et te oro, prómissa ut servés tua.
1145 ibo ad uxorem intro, missum facio Teresiam senem.
1146 nunc, spectatores, Iovis súmmi causa clare plaudite.

1131 Be of good cheer, Amphitryon; I am come to thy aid: thou hast nothing to fear; all diviners and soothsayers let alone. What is to be, and what has past, I will tell thee; and so much better than they can, inasmuch as I am Jupiter. 1135 First of all, I have made loan of the person of Alcmena, and have caused her to be pregnant with a son. Thou, too, didst cause her to be pregnant, when thou didst set out upon the expedition; at one birth has she brought forth the two together. One of these, the one that is sprung from my parentage, 1140 shall bless thee with deathless glory by his deeds. Do thou return with Alcmena to your former affection; she merits not that thou shouldst impute it to her as her blame; by my power has she been compelled thus to act. I now return to the heavens. 1144 I’ll do as

thou dost command me; and I entreat thee to keep thy promises. 1145 I’ll go in-doors to my wife. I dismiss the aged Tiresias from my thoughts. 1146 Spectators, now, for the sake of supreme Jove , give loud applause.